A Project Report on

"A study on Wealth creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities"

A Project Report submitted in partial Fulfilment of Master of Business Administration (MBA)

DON BOSCO INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT

Submitted by: Manash Boro

ID No. – DI2024MBA0023

MBA 3rd Semester

ORGANIZATIONAL GUIDE

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Manager(faculty)

SBILD, Guwahati

INSTITUTIONAL GUIDE

Mr. Bikash Kalita

Assistant Professor

DBIM

CERTIFICATE OF ORIGINALITY

This is to certify that the project report titled "**Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities**" is an original and genuine work carried out and submitted by Mr. Manash Boro, an intern under SBI, LHO Guwahati, in partial fulfilment of the Summer Internship course.

The content of this report is based on authentic research and has been prepared sincerely by the student under my supervision. I confirm that the work is original and has not been copied from any other source.

I wish him all the very best and great success in his future endeavours.

Date: Mr. Nipon Das

Place: Manager(faculty)

SBILD, Guwahati

State Bank of India

DECLARATION

I, Manash Boro, hereby declare that this project report titled "**Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities**" submitted to the State Bank of India, LHO, Guwahati, in partial fulfilment of the requirements of my Summer Internship is a Bonafide work carried out by me.

This report has been completed under the valuable guidance of Mr. Nipon Das, and all the data and content presented is original and has been compiled sincerely for academic and practical purposes.

Date: Manash Boro

Place: MBA 3rd Semester

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to Mr. Bikash Kalita, my institutional guide, and Mr. Nipon Das, my organizational mentor at SBI LHO, Guwahati, for their extremely helpful guidance, constant encouragement, and insightful suggestions throughout the course of this project titled "**A Study on Wealth Creation Through Strategic Investment Opportunities.**" Their support played a key role in the successful completion of this study.

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Manash Boro

(DI2024MBA0023)

Executive Summary

Title of the Project:	Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities
Duration:	This project was conducted over a period of 8 weeks, from June 2025 to July 2025.
Name of the Guide:	Mr. Nipon Das
Objectives:	• To examine the preferred investment avenues, planning habits, risk tolerance, and financial awareness of individual investors. • To evaluate investor satisfaction and the use of digital platforms for managing investments. • To provide strategic recommendations for improving wealth creation among new and beginner investors.
Research Methodology:	**Nature of Data:** • Primary data collected through a structured questionnaire (both online and offline). **Sampling Technique:** • Convenience Sampling and Snowball Sampling **Statistical Tools Used:** • Microsoft Excel • Chi-Square Test (to examine relationships between variables) • Cronbach's Alpha (for testing reliability of Likert-scale questions)
Findings:	• A significant majority of respondents (95.5%) are active investors, with mutual funds, PPF, and fixed deposits being the most preferred avenues. However, only 28% plan their investments in detail. • Most investors demonstrate moderate risk tolerance (83%) and are comfortable using digital platforms (71%), yet over 50% still depend on friends and family for advice rather than professionals. • Chi-square analysis revealed no strong relationship between having a strategy or being risk-aware and feeling satisfied with returns — highlighting a gap between knowledge and actual investment behaviour. • Overall, while investors appear confident and aware, they often lack structured financial planning, emotional control, and professional guidance — which limits their ability to achieve effective wealth creation.

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CHAPTER – 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 COMPANY PROFILE

Field	Information (as of FY 2024–25)
Formerly	Imperial Bank of India
Type	Public Sector Undertaking
Traded as	NSE: SBIN BSE: 500112 LSE: SBID BSE SENSEX Constituent NSE NIFTY 50 Constituent
ISIN	INE062A01020
Industry	Banking, Financial Services
Predecessor	Imperial Bank of India (1921–1955) Bank of Calcutta (1806–1921) Bank of Bombay (1840–1921) Bank of Madras (1843–1921)
Founded	1 July 1955
Corporate Office	Mumbai, Maharashtra, India
Number of branches	22,937 branches; 63,791 ATMs (India); 244 international branches in 29 countries
Area served	Worldwide
Key people	• Shri Challa Sreenivasulu Setty – Chairman (appointed 28 August 2024) • Shri Ashwini Kumar Tewari – Managing Director (Corporate Banking & Subsidiaries) • Shri Vinay M. Tonse – Managing Director (Retail Business & Operations) • Shri Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh – Managing Director (Risk, Compliance & SARG) • Shri Rama Mohan Rao Amara - Managing Director (International Banking, Global Markets & Technology)
Products	Retail banking Corporate banking Investment banking Mortgage loans

	Private banking Wealth management Asset & Investment management Credit cards Insurance
No. of YONO users	8.8 crore registered users (as per latest data)
Net Profit	₹70,901 crore for FY 2024–25
Total assets	₹66,76,053 crore (i.e., over ₹66 lakh crore) as of 31 March 2025
No. of SBI customers	Over 52 crore customer accounts
Number of employees	236,226 (as of 31 March 2025)
Subsidiaries	SBI Life Insurance Ltd SBI Mutual Fund (63%) SBI Cards & Payment Services Ltd (68.63%) SBI General Insurance (69.11%) SBI Capital Markets Ltd (SBICAPS) SBICAP Securities Ltd SBICAP Trustee Co. Ltd BI DFHI Ltd SBI Payment Services Pvt Ltd SBI Factors Ltd SBI Pension Funds Pvt Ltd State Bank Operations Support Services Pvt Ltd (SBOSS) SBI Foundation SBI Canada Bank State Bank of India (California) SBI (Mauritius) Ltd State Bank of India (UK) Ltd Nepal SBI Bank Ltd (55%) PT Bank SBI Indonesia Commercial Indo Bank LLC, Moscow Bank of Bhutan Ltd (20%)
Parent	Ministry of Finance (Government of India, ~57.5% stake)
Website	www.bank.sbi / sbi.co.in

OVERVIEW OF STATE BANK OF INDIA (SBI)

1.2 Overview of State Bank of India (SBI)

The State Bank of India (SBI) is not just India's largest commercial bank but also one of the oldest and most influential institutions in the country's economic history. With a legacy that spans over 200 years, SBI plays a foundational role in the Indian banking and financial system. It serves as a vital institution for financial intermediation, social empowerment, and national economic growth.

Headquartered at Nariman Point, Mumbai, SBI offers a vast reach that combines both traditional branch-based banking and modern digital channels. As of 2025, SBI operates approximately 23,000 domestic branches, around 63,731 ATMs, and over 77,200 Business Correspondent (BC) outlets across India (State Bank of India, 2024; Capital Market, 2025). These figures underline the bank's ability to penetrate deep into rural and underbanked regions. Its extensive reach ensures that millions of Indians—regardless of geography, income, or social class—can access formal financial services.

With a customer base exceeding 500 million, SBI caters to a broad spectrum including salaried professionals, self-employed individuals, farmers, rural artisans, MSMEs, large corporations, and governmental bodies. The bank's strong international presence includes 244 overseas offices in 29 countries, supporting NRIs, Indian exporters/importers, and international financial operations.

SBI's core areas of service include:

- Retail Banking: Savings accounts, loans, deposits, debit/credit cards
- Corporate and SME Banking: Working capital, project finance, trade services
- Agricultural Finance: Kisan Credit Cards, Agri-loans, rural development schemes
- Wealth and Investment Services: Mutual funds, portfolio advisory, Demat services
- International Banking: Remittances, NRI accounts, foreign exchange

Moreover, SBI leads in implementing social schemes such as:

- Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)
- PM Awas Yojana
- Stand-Up India, Mudra Yojana
- Financial literacy campaigns, especially in rural areas

These efforts reflect SBI's identity as not only a banking leader but also a nation-building institution.

1.3 Vision, Mission & Core Values of SBI

EVOLUTION AND HISTORY OF STATE BANK OF INDIA (SBI)

1.4 Evolution and History of SBI

The State Bank of India (SBI) is not only a modern financial powerhouse but also the oldest commercial bank in the Indian subcontinent. Its historical roots date back to June 2, 1806, with the establishment of the Bank of Calcutta in Bengal Presidency, under the British East India Company. This was later renamed the Bank of Bengal in 1809. Two more presidency banks were established: the Bank of Bombay (1840) and the Bank of Madras (1843). These three served as quasi-central banks for their respective presidencies and played a key role in managing currency, government borrowing, and trade finance during British rule (Wikipedia contributors, 2025; Biographies on Bank of Calcutta et al., 2025).

In 1921, these three presidency banks were merged to form the Imperial Bank of India, which became the largest commercial bank in undivided India (Wikipedia contributors, 2025; Biographies on Bank of Calcutta et al., 2025). It functioned as both a commercial bank and performed some central banking functions until the establishment of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) in 1935.

Post-independence, the Indian government aimed to create a stronger, nationalized banking institution to support the country's socio-economic development goals such as agricultural growth, rural financing, industrial development, and nationwide financial inclusion. As a result, in 1955, the Imperial Bank of India was nationalized and reconstituted as the State Bank of India, with the RBI holding a controlling interest.

To further strengthen the banking system, several associate banks, often founded by princely states, were brought under SBI's umbrella as subsidiaries:

- State Bank of Bikaner & Jaipur (SBBJ)
- State Bank of Hyderabad (SBH)
- State Bank of Mysore (SBM)
- State Bank of Patiala (SBP)
- State Bank of Travancore (SBT)

All of these were fully merged into SBI in April 2017, marking one of the biggest consolidation efforts in the Indian banking sector. This merger further enhanced SBI's reach, branch strength, and customer base, giving it unmatched scale and operational efficiency.

Technological Evolution

SBI has consistently embraced change and innovation to stay relevant:

- 1990s: Among the first Indian banks to implement Core Banking Solutions (CBS), linking all branches to a centralized server.
- Early 2000s: Launched SBI Online for internet banking, followed by SBI Mobile Banking and SMS alerts.
- 2017: Introduced YONO (You Only Need One) — an integrated digital banking and lifestyle app allowing customers to bank, shop, invest, and insure through one platform.
- 2020–2025: Integrated AI and machine learning for risk profiling, fraud detection, biometric authentication, and robo-advisory services.

Today, SBI stands as a symbol of continuity and modernization, balancing heritage with innovation. Its contribution to India's rural economy, infrastructure finance, digital inclusion, and international banking makes it a legacy institution that is future-ready.

1.5 Group Structure and Subsidiaries of SBI

The State Bank Group is one of the most diversified and integrated financial services networks in India. It offers a 360-degree portfolio of financial products through its wholly-owned subsidiaries, joint ventures, and strategic alliances.

These subsidiaries serve distinct financial needs ranging from life insurance to mutual funds, capital markets, and retirement planning, thus allowing SBI to act as a universal financial solution provider.

a) SBI Life Insurance Company Ltd.

- Established in partnership with BNP Paribas Cardif, later became a publicly listed entity.
- Offers term insurance, ULIPs, endowment policies, retirement and pension plans.
- Has a large agency and bancassurance network.
- One of the top private life insurers in India by new business premium.

b) SBI General Insurance Company Ltd.

- Provides **non-life insurance products**: health, motor, travel, personal accident, property, and commercial insurance.
- Serves both individual and business segments.
- Known for its claim settlement record and distribution reach across urban and semi-urban India.

c) SBI Mutual Fund (Managed by SBI Funds Management Pt. Ltd.)

- A joint venture with AMUNDI (France).
- Offers a wide range of investment products: equity funds, debt funds, hybrid funds, ELSS, ETFs, etc.
- Known for large investor base and trusted fund performance.
- Helps small investors build wealth via Systematic Investment Plans (SIPs).

4. SBI Cards and Payment Services Ltd.

- India’s second-largest credit card issuer.
- Provides a variety of cards: lifestyle, co-branded (with IRCTC, Air India, BPCL), premium, and contactless.
- Listed on Indian stock exchanges.
- Offers rewards, EMI conversion, and digital bill payment facilities.

d) SBI Capital Markets Ltd. (SBICAPS)

- A premier investment banking arm.

- Services include debt syndication, project finance, structured finance, M&A advisory, and capital market issuance.
- Known for advising on infrastructure projects and PSU disinvestments.

e) SBICAP Securities Ltd.

- Offers retail stock broking and wealth management.
- Services include equity trading, mutual funds, IPO investment, and portfolio analysis tools.
- Integrated with YONO for convenient investing.

f) SBI Funds Management Pvt. Ltd.

- One of the most experienced Asset Management Companies (AMCs) in India.
- Manages both retail and institutional investments.
- Operates large pension, retirement, and corporate fund portfolios.

g) SBI Pension Funds Pvt. Ltd.

- Appointed by the PFRDA (Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority).
- Manages pension assets under the National Pension System (NPS).
- Caters to both government and private-sector subscribers.

h) SBI DFHI Ltd. (Discount and Finance House of India)

- Operates in the money market and debt instruments space.
- Acts as a primary dealer in government securities and repo transactions.

i) SBI Foundation

- CSR and social development arm.
- Works in sectors such as education, healthcare, environment, women empowerment, and rural entrepreneurship.
- Runs flagship programs like SBI Youth for India Fellowship.

INTRODUCTION TO WEALTH AND WEALTH CREATION

1.6 Introduction to Wealth and Wealth Creation

Wealth can be defined as the accumulation of valuable resources—both tangible and intangible—that provide economic security and future financial stability. It includes physical assets such as land, real estate, and gold, as well as financial assets like stocks, bonds, mutual funds, fixed deposits, and pension schemes. Wealth is not merely measured by possession, but by the ability of those assets to generate consistent income, preserve value over time, and contribute to long-term financial independence.

Wealth creation, therefore, is the process by which individuals or institutions increase their net worth through systematic financial planning, disciplined savings, and wise investments. In the traditional Indian context, wealth was mostly inherited or accumulated through agriculture, property, or gold. These forms of wealth, while secure, often lacked liquidity, growth potential, and diversification.

In the modern economic landscape, wealth creation has evolved into a dynamic process involving goal-oriented planning, awareness of financial products, and understanding of risk and return. It is no longer restricted to the wealthy elite. With the advancement of financial literacy, regulatory reforms, and digital access, even salaried individuals, students, and small business owners can participate in strategic wealth-building.

Key pillars of modern wealth creation include:

- **Diversification and Asset Allocation**: Distributing investments across asset classes like equity, debt, real estate, and commodities to minimize risk and optimize returns.
- **Market-Linked Investment Vehicles**: Systematic Investment Plans (SIPs), Exchange-Traded Funds (ETFs), and direct equity allow participation in wealth-generating financial markets.
- **Insurance and Retirement Planning**: Instruments like life insurance, ULIPs, and pension plans ensure future financial protection and passive income post-retirement.
- **Tax Planning**: Utilizing tools like ELSS, PPF, and NPS to build wealth while reducing tax liability.
- **Digital Enablement**: Mobile apps and fintech platforms empower users to access, invest, track, and learn—all in real-time with minimal barriers.

Today, wealth creation is considered a **lifelong, strategic activity**, supported by data, technology, and evolving investment products.

1.7 Vision & Mission of SBI Wealth

In a fast-growing economy, SBI Wealth sees financial well-being of clients and aims to integrate client's objective with their financial journey.

Vision –

To become synonymous with an inclusive idea of wealth creation with benefits having a far-reaching impact.

Mission –

To provide unmatched products, incisive expertise, and premium privileges with focus on client experience and quality in service delivery

1.8 Strategic Investment Opportunities in India

India's investment culture has undergone a major transformation, especially after the 1991 economic liberalization, which opened up markets, increased financial product offerings, and introduced private sector competition. With a young population, rising middle class, and increasing digitization, the country presents a fertile ground for strategic investment opportunities.

Strategic investment refers to the intentional, goal-based allocation of funds into instruments that are expected to provide superior long-term returns, while also balancing risk and liquidity. Unlike ad-hoc or impulsive investing, strategic investing is guided by planning, research, diversification, and periodic review.

Prominent strategic investment options available to Indian investors include:

- **Mutual Funds**: Managed by professionals, mutual funds allow diversification even with small investments. SIPs make it easier to invest regularly and reduce market timing risk.
- **Public Provident Fund (PPF)**: A government-backed, long-term savings scheme with tax benefits under Section 80C, offering fixed and secure returns over 15 years.
- **National Pension System (NPS)**: A voluntary retirement savings tool regulated by PFRDA that combines equity and debt exposure to build a retirement corpus.
- **Stock Market & Equity ETFs**: For investors seeking higher returns, equity markets and ETFs provide exposure to specific sectors, indices, or global trends.
- **Sovereign Gold Bonds & Digital Gold**: A modern alternative to physical gold with added advantages like interest income and safety from theft or purity issues.
- **ULIPs and Insurance-Linked Investments**: These combine wealth creation with life coverage and can be customized to match various life-stage goals.
- **Corporate Bonds & Debentures**: For conservative investors seeking regular interest income with lower volatility compared to equity.

Technology has significantly increased access to these products. Platforms like YONO by SBI, Zerodha, Groww, ET Money, and Paytm Money allow investors to start investing with as little as ₹100, conduct research, automate SIPs, and analyze portfolios without relying on intermediaries.

The rise of AI-driven robo-advisors, personal finance tools, and goal-setting calculators has further enhanced investor confidence and decision-making. Features like risk profiling, portfolio rebalancing, and real-time market alerts help individuals align their investments with financial goals such as retirement, education, home purchase, or wealth accumulation.

Thus, the Indian investment ecosystem today offers a wide array of strategic opportunities that are:

- Transparent and well-regulated
- Digitally accessible
- Customizable to income level, risk appetite, and financial goals

These developments ensure that strategic investment is not just an option but a necessity for long-term wealth creation, especially in an era of rising inflation, uncertain employment, and financial aspirations.

1.9 Research Question

- What are the commonly used strategic investment avenues preferred by individual investors for wealth creation?
- How do factors such as investment behavior, risk tolerance, and financial awareness influence wealth-building outcomes?
- To what extent are investors satisfied with their current returns, and how aligned are these returns with their long-term financial goals?

1.10 Statement of the Problem

Despite the increasing availability of strategic investment options in India, many individuals continue to rely heavily on traditional savings methods like fixed deposits, physical gold, or informal schemes that offer low or stagnant returns. This limits their ability to build long-term wealth and protect against inflation.

A significant portion of the population lacks financial literacy, proper investment planning, and awareness of digital tools available for wealth creation. Factors such as emotional decision-making, poor understanding of risk, and short-term mindset further hinder effective financial growth.

Even though platforms like SBI's YONO and other digital fintech apps provide simplified access to mutual funds, SIPs, and other wealth-building products, many investors do not fully utilize them due to lack of trust, guidance, or knowledge. Moreover, beginner and retail investors often struggle with aligning their investment choices to specific life goals, leading to low satisfaction with outcomes.

Addressing these challenges is essential to promote informed, disciplined, and goal-oriented investment behavior that can support sustainable wealth creation for all income groups in the modern Indian economy.

1.11 Objectives of the Study

The primary objectives of this study are as follows:

a) To examine the preferred investment avenues, behavior, planning habits, risk tolerance, and financial awareness of individual investors.
b) To evaluate investor satisfaction, and provide strategic recommendations for effective wealth creation.
c) To provide strategic recommendations for improving wealth creation among new and beginner investors.

1.12 Significance of the Study

This study aims to contribute valuable insights to the existing body of research on individual investment behavior and wealth creation in India. By examining the preferences, planning habits, risk tolerance, financial awareness, and satisfaction levels of investors, the study provides a holistic view of how individuals are approaching wealth-building in the current economic landscape.

The findings will be useful for beginner investors, financial educators, and policy-makers seeking to promote better financial decision-making and investment practices. It will help identify gaps in awareness, behavioral patterns, and strategic planning that impact long-term wealth creation.

Furthermore, the study supports the goal of enhancing financial literacy and encouraging more people—especially from low and middle-income groups—to shift from traditional savings methods to informed and goal-oriented investment strategies**.** These insights can be applied to design better awareness programs, create supportive investment frameworks, and guide individuals toward more secure financial futures.

1.13 Limitations of the Study

a) The study is limited to a specific geographic area and sample group, which may not represent all investor profiles across India. Therefore, the findings may not be fully generalizable.
b) The responses collected are based on self-reported data, which may carry personal biases, misunderstandings, or intentional misreporting, affecting the accuracy of the results.
c) Some respondents may be unwilling to disclose complete or honest information about their financial behavior, which could lead to partial or less reliable data.
d) The study focuses only on individual investors and excludes institutional investors, which might have offered broader insights into strategic investment practices.
e) The dynamic nature of financial markets means that some investment trends or preferences might change rapidly, possibly impacting the long-term relevance of the findings.
f) The Chi-square tests used in this study are valid only for the 200 respondents. Since the sample size is small, the results cannot be generalized to a larger population.

1.14 Conclusion

The exploration of wealth creation through strategic investment opportunities reveals the growing importance of informed financial planning in today's economic environment. With the evolution of India's investment ecosystem, individuals now have access to a wide range of financial instruments such as mutual funds, PPF, NPS, ETFs, and digital platforms that simplify investing. However, this abundance of options also highlights challenges related to awareness, behavioral discipline, and risk understanding among retail investors.

While traditional savings methods continue to hold relevance, they often fall short in terms of long-term growth and inflation protection. Strategic investing, on the other hand, emphasizes diversification, goal alignment, and consistent review—factors that are essential for sustainable wealth accumulation. Despite the availability of tools and platforms, many individuals still rely on informal advice or emotional decision-making, which limits the effectiveness of their investment strategies.

There is a pressing need to bridge the gap between financial awareness and actionable planning. Strengthening investor education, promoting digital adoption, and encouraging disciplined investing can empower individuals to make more strategic choices. Institutions like SBI, through initiatives such as YONO and SBI Wealth, play a pivotal role in supporting this transition by offering accessible and integrated financial solutions.

Addressing these gaps is essential for enhancing investor confidence, improving financial outcomes, and ensuring a more inclusive model of wealth creation. As the study progresses, it will further examine investor behavior, strategic practices, and the role of digital tools in transforming how individuals build and preserve wealth over time.

CHAPTER – 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Literature Review

A literature review is a critical analysis and summary of existing academic work related to a specific topic. It helps identify the current state of knowledge, existing research gaps, and emerging trends within the chosen subject area. This section plays a vital role in academic research by examining books, peer-reviewed journals, and other relevant sources to build a strong foundation for further study. Through this comprehensive evaluation, researchers gain a deeper understanding of the topic and position their work within the broader academic discussion. By acknowledging previous contributions, the literature review ensures that new research is well-informed, relevant, and aligned with the existing body of knowledge.

(Gallant, 2017) discussed a four-step method for building a profitable investment portfolio. He explained that investors should start by understanding their financial goals and risk levels to decide on asset allocation. The article showed how diversification using stocks, bonds, mutual funds, and ETFs helped reduce risk. Gallant also highlighted the importance of regularly rebalancing the portfolio and selecting securities carefully. He pointed out challenges like market volatility, emotional decisions, and high costs. Overall, the study stressed a disciplined and long-term investment approach.

(Management, 2021)studied how global investors were underinvesting in emerging markets (EM) despite their strong economic growth and high return potential. The report discussed EM assets like equities, commodities, and digital sectors and found that EM countries made up a large portion of global GDP but had much smaller allocations in global portfolios. The authors explained this gap was mainly due to "home bias," where investors preferred domestic assets. They used models like GDP-weighted and market-cap-based approaches to recommend higher EM allocations, around 26–27%. However, investors faced challenges such as political risk, currency issues, market volatility, and lack of awareness. The study suggested that increasing EM exposure could offer better diversification and long-term returns.

(Chhabra, 2021) examined the flaws of Modern Portfolio Theory (MPT) when applied to individual investors. He found that despite MPT's focus on diversification, many investors still held risky, undiversified portfolios due to overconfidence and behavioral biases. The study explained that traditional models ignored personal factors like human capital, lifestyle, and individual risk tolerance. To solve this, Chhabra proposed a new three-part framework focusing on personal, market, and aspirational risks. This approach included non-financial assets, personal goals, and risk budgeting to help investors build portfolios better suited to their real-life situations.

(Dallas, 2022) created an educational workbook to teach individuals how to build personal wealth. The guide explained that wealth means more than money—it includes financial security and future goals. It highlighted steps like setting goals, budgeting, saving regularly, investing wisely, managing credit, and controlling debt. The workbook also encouraged entrepreneurship and gave real-life examples to show how planning and discipline lead to success. It pointed out challenges such as emotional spending, market risks, debt, and economic changes. Overall, the guide offered simple, practical advice to help people take control of their financial future.

An article from **(Doshi, 2024)** explained eight strategies used to manage the wealth of Ultra High Net Worth Individuals (UHNIs). It showed how UHNIs used a mix of traditional and alternative assets like stocks, bonds, private equity, and hedge funds. The article highlighted the importance of tax-saving methods, managing liquidity, making direct investments, and planning for future generations. It also discussed how UHNIs included philanthropy and risk management in their financial plans. The article pointed out challenges like market risks, complex tax rules, and handling illiquid assets. Overall, it focused on creating personalized portfolios to protect and grow wealth.

(Dave, 2022) discussed the concept of wealth creation and explained how it helps in achieving financial freedom and reducing poverty. He said wealth is not just income but includes long-term investments in assets like stocks, bonds, real estate, and gold. The paper highlighted the importance of starting early, investing regularly, diversifying, and staying disciplined. It also pointed out challenges like lack of financial knowledge, market risks, overborrowing, emotional spending, and inconsistent investing habits. The study stressed that cultural traits and economic freedom also affect how people create wealth. Overall, it encouraged financial education and long-term planning to build and grow wealth.

(Johnson, 2014) explored the connection between wealth creation and social capital using two frameworks—economic and sociological. He explained that wealth includes financial, real, natural, human, and social assets, and wealth creation happens by investing in these assets while managing them well. The paper focused on how social norms, trust, and networks (social capital) can lower costs and improve cooperation, which helps in building wealth. Johnson argued that combining both frameworks gives a clearer picture of how communities create and share wealth. He also pointed out challenges like differences in concepts, measuring intangible assets, and unequal benefits. Overall, the study supported a balanced approach that includes both economic and social factors for better wealth-building and policymaking.

(Håvard Halland et. al 2016) studied the rise of Strategic Investment Funds (SIFs) set up by governments to achieve both financial returns and development goals. These funds invest in sectors like infrastructure, real estate, and manufacturing using public capital while attracting private investment. The authors explained that SIFs balance a "double bottom line"—profit and public benefit—and act as long-term investors offering equity, debt, or fund-based investments. However, they face challenges like finding good projects, managing political influence, hiring skilled staff, and measuring social impact. The study concluded that well-managed SIFs can support national growth by acting as catalysts for private investment and policy-driven development.

(Media, 2023) published a practical guide on wealth creation, focusing on long-term financial planning and disciplined investing. The guide stressed the importance of setting personal goals, managing risks, and diversifying across asset classes like stocks, bonds, mutual funds, real estate, and fixed-income products. It also highlighted the need for emergency savings, tax planning, and avoiding scams. The authors warned against emotional investing and promoted strategies like asset allocation and estate planning. Overall, the guide served as a useful financial roadmap for building wealth through careful planning and steady investment habits.

(Khiloshiya, 2023) conducted an academic study on wealth management practices in Nagpur City, focusing on how individuals from various sectors plan and manage their finances. The research explored goal-based and comprehensive financial planning, asset allocation strategies, and investment choices like stocks, mutual funds, real estate, and gold. It also classified investors based on their risk appetite and highlighted challenges such as low financial literacy, market volatility, and emotional biases. The study concluded that effective wealth management requires structured planning, proper diversification, and awareness of financial tools to achieve long-term stability.

(Investments, 2024), in their educational guide Investment Strategy: Interpreting Key Concepts and Choosing Appropriate Strategies, outlined a structured approach to long-term investing. The guide emphasizes strategic asset allocation as the primary driver of portfolio performance, along with diversification, regular rebalancing, and tax-efficient investing. It highlights common challenges like market volatility, emotional decision-making, and tax complexities, advising investors to stay disciplined and avoid market timing. Overall, it promotes consistent, goal-based investing for better long-term outcomes.

(Dr. M. R. Jhansi Rani et. al 2024) conducted an exploratory study on how life insurance contributes to wealth creation among individual investors in Bengaluru. Published in the ISBR Management Journal, the research emphasizes that products like ULIPs go beyond protection, offering market-linked returns and tax benefits. Based on a survey of 385 respondents and analysed using ANOVA and SEM, the study found low investor awareness despite the wealth-building potential of life insurance. Key barriers include limited financial literacy, market volatility, and high fees. The authors recommend improving financial education, digital access, and product transparency to enhance adoption.

(Mirae Asset, 2024) published an investor education guide highlighting the long-term wealth creation potential of equity investments. It presents equity as a high-return asset class compared to fixed income, gold, and real estate, especially when accessed through mutual funds. The guide emphasizes diversification, tax efficiency, and structured portfolio strategies tailored to investor goals and risk tolerance. Challenges such as market volatility, emotional investing, and tax planning errors are noted, with equity mutual funds positioned as ideal tools for accessible, professionally managed, and growth-oriented investing.

(Dr. Aashka Thakkar et. al, 2025), in their journal article published in the International Journal of Research Publication and Reviews, explored how mutual funds support long-term wealth creation for retail investors. Analyzing data from SEBI, AMFI, and surveys, the study highlights the benefits of equity funds, SIPs, and diversified portfolios in outperforming traditional investments like fixed deposits. It emphasizes the role of financial literacy in maximizing returns and identifies key challenges such as market volatility, behavioral biases, and limited investor awareness. The authors recommend financial education and disciplined investing to improve mutual fund adoption and outcomes.

(Achari et. al, 2023), in their journal article published in the International Journal of Research Publication and Reviews, examined investment and wealth management practices at Reliance Nippon Life Insurance in Hyderabad. The study highlights how financial advisory services, asset allocation, and tax planning contribute to effective wealth creation for both retail and high-net-worth investors. It also discusses trends such as digital platforms and growing equity participation, while identifying challenges like market volatility, low financial literacy, and regulatory constraints. The authors recommend structured financial planning and improved advisory support to address these issues.

(V. V. Rakshani et. al, 2025), in their article published in IJARIIE, challenge the widespread belief that real estate guarantees wealth creation in India. The study highlights the risks of property investments, such as high capital costs, debt burdens, market volatility, and liquidity issues. Using data analysis and risk metrics, the authors argue for portfolio diversification through mutual funds and bonds, which offer better liquidity, lower costs, and more stable returns. The paper stresses the need for financial awareness and balanced investing to avoid over-reliance on real estate

(Lasater, 2024), in his book The Strategic Investor, outlines a comprehensive approach to wealth creation through real estate, with a focus on multi-family properties. Drawing from two decades of experience, he emphasizes strategic asset selection, cash flow management, tax advantages, and risk mitigation. The book covers key investment models like buy-and-hold, fix-and-flip, and REITs, while highlighting challenges such as market volatility, liquidity issues, and regulatory risks. Lasater advocates disciplined investing, thorough deal analysis, and geographic diversification as essential to building sustainable real estate wealth.

(Finserv, 2024), in its investment report Wealth Creation Ka Sabse Intelligent Plan, outlines a structured approach to long-term wealth creation through SIPs, mutual funds, and behavioural finance. Emphasizing strategies like moat investing, megatrend funds, and Savings+ for surplus cash, the report highlights India’s strong economic outlook and sectoral opportunities. It warns against short-term bias, emotional decision-making, and tax inefficiencies, advocating disciplined, diversified investing. Backed by quantitative models and market insights, the report encourages long-term, goal-based investment planning.

(Tudor Franklin, 2022), in its Guide to Wealth Creation, presents a structured financial planning approach for achieving personal financial freedom. It emphasizes goal-based investing, diversified asset allocation across stocks, bonds, mutual funds, and real estate, and the importance of risk tolerance. The guide addresses behavioural finance pitfalls like herd mentality and emotional investing, and encourages tax-efficient strategies through ISAs and retirement accounts. Regular portfolio reviews and disciplined investing are advocated for long-term wealth accumulation and stability.

2.2 Research Gap

While various studies have explored investment behavior, financial literacy, and saving patterns among Indian individuals, most of them tend to focus on specific products (like mutual funds, gold, or real estate) or on the general awareness of financial instruments. These studies often do not provide a holistic view of how investor behavior, planning habits, risk appetite, and satisfaction levels interact to influence wealth creation.

Additionally, there is a noticeable lack of research that combines investment preferences, behavioral patterns, financial awareness, and goal alignment in a single study—especially from the perspective of retail investors who are now more exposed to digital and diversified investment options.

Although digital transformation is mentioned in existing literature, very few studies have examined how factors like planning discipline, risk understanding, and investor confidence affect the practical outcomes of wealth creation.

This study aims to fill this gap by analyzing the investment avenues chosen, the investment behavior, risk tolerance, awareness levels, and overall satisfaction of individual investors. It seeks to provide strategic insights for better wealth creation, especially for new and less-experienced investors.

2.3 Conclusion

The literature reviewed offers a broad understanding of how wealth can be created through strategic investment decisions. Studies emphasize the significance of financial planning, diversification, disciplined investing, and awareness of risk factors as core elements of successful wealth creation. Key insights also reveal the growing importance of personal goal alignment, investor behavior, and digital tools in shaping modern investment strategies.

It is evident that traditional models such as Modern Portfolio Theory, while valuable, often overlook individual-specific factors like human capital, emotional biases, and personal aspirations. Moreover, frameworks like Strategic Investment Funds (SIFs) and social capital-based models show that wealth creation is influenced not only by financial returns but also by broader socio-economic impacts.

Despite this wide coverage, existing research tends to examine wealth creation in fragmented ways—focusing on isolated products or investor traits. The lack of a unified view that integrates behavior, awareness, risk tolerance, and satisfaction among retail investors presents a significant research gap.

This study addresses that gap by exploring how strategic investment choices, supported by financial discipline and awareness, can enhance long-term wealth outcomes for individual investors. It aims to provide practical insights that can guide informed financial decisions in today's evolving investment landscape.

CHAPTER-3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 INTRODUCTION

Research methodology refers to the structured process and techniques used to identify, collect, analyze, and interpret information to better understand a research problem and derive meaningful conclusions.

This study was conducted in Guwahati, Assam**,** focusing on individual investors engaged in various forms of personal investment activities. The research methodology outlines the design of the study, the nature of the research, target respondents, sampling method, data collection procedures, research instrument, and tools used for analysis.

The aim of this section is to explain how the study was systematically planned and executed to ensure reliability, relevance, and alignment with the research objectives.

3.2 RESEARCH DESIGN

Research design serves as the backbone of any study, guiding its structure, direction, and overall validity. In this research, careful attention has been given to selecting participants based on key demographic factors such as age group, income level, and occupation to ensure proper representation of the target population. This is essential for achieving accurate and generalizable findings.

The present study titled **"Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities"** follows a descriptive research design, which is best suited for observing and describing the existing investment behaviour, preferences, financial planning habits, risk tolerance, and satisfaction levels of individual investors. Descriptive research helps in presenting "what is" — without attempting to influence or manipulate the variables under study.

This design supports the use of a quantitative research approach, relying on a structured, closed-ended questionnaire to collect data from a broad sample of retail investors. The data includes responses on the type and frequency of investments, percentage of income invested, use of financial tools, and investor satisfaction levels.

By using this descriptive and quantitative design, the study aims to uncover patterns and relationships in how investors make financial decisions, and to provide valuable insights for improving long-term wealth creation strategies — especially for beginner and less-experienced investors. The results are expected to guide educators, advisors, and individuals in developing more informed and disciplined investment practices.

This design ensures minimal bias and maximum coverage of real-world investor behaviour, aligning well with the study's objectives.

3.3 RESEARCH NATURE

The nature of this study is purely quantitative, focusing on the collection and statistical analysis of numerical data related to investment behavior, financial preferences, risk tolerance, satisfaction levels, and financial awareness.

The data has been gathered through a structured, closed-ended questionnaire designed to capture responses in a measurable format. Questions include multiple-choice options, Likert scale items, and checkbox responses, which allow for easy comparison and statistical interpretation.

This quantitative approach enables the researcher to draw meaningful insights from a larger sample, identify patterns in investor behavior, and make objective conclusions regarding wealth creation strategies. It also ensures that the findings are reliable, consistent, and suitable for generalizing across a broader population of individual investors.

3.4 AREA OF THE STUDY

The area of the study is focused on Guwahati, Assam. Data was collected from individual investors living in the city using both online surveys (Google Forms) and offline interactions at various bank branches.

Respondents included salaried professionals, self-employed individuals, students, and retired persons who are actively involved in different types of personal investment activities. The offline data was collected from banks like SBI, ICICI, HDFC, and PNB, while the online survey was shared through email, WhatsApp, and social media platforms.

The study reflects the investment behaviour, planning habits, and financial awareness of individual investors in Guwahati.

3.5 SOURCE OF DATA

To fulfil the objectives of this study, primary data has been collected through a structured questionnaire from individual investors. The questionnaire was designed to capture responses related to investment behaviour, risk tolerance, financial awareness, planning habits, and satisfaction levels with current investment returns.

The respondents include people from different age groups, income levels, and occupational backgrounds who are actively involved in personal financial planning and investment activities. The collected data aims to provide insights into the real-life investment practices and strategies adopted by retail investors for long-term wealth creation.

3.6 SAMPLING TECHNIQUE

Sampling is a fundamental process in research that involves selecting a representative group from a larger population for the purpose of collecting relevant data. For this study, a combination of Convenience Sampling and Snowball Sampling methods has been adopted.

Convenience sampling is a type of non-probability sampling where participants are selected based on their easy accessibility and willingness to respond. This method is especially useful when time, resources, and access to a complete population list are limited. In the context of this study on strategic investment behaviour among individual investors, convenience sampling was chosen due to the following reasons:

- **Accessibility of Respondents:** Since the study focuses on individual investors across various income levels, age groups, and professions, it is challenging to obtain a comprehensive list of all active investors. Therefore, individuals who were easily reachable through digital platforms, educational institutions, banks, or personal networks were approached to participate in the survey.
- **Time Constraints:** The research was conducted during a limited internship period of two months. Given this time frame, convenience sampling allowed for quick data collection from a sizable sample without requiring complex sampling frameworks or extended outreach efforts.

- **Wider Reach Through Digital Platforms:** Many of the responses were collected using online tools such as Google Forms. The survey link was circulated via social media platforms, emails, and messaging apps, enabling broader access to a diverse group of investors, though still within the bounds of convenience.

In addition to convenience sampling, **snowball sampling** was also applied. This method involves existing participants referring others who share similar characteristics or investment interests. After initial responses were gathered, some participants—such as friends, colleagues, and banking professionals—were requested to forward the survey to other potential respondents within their network. This strategy helped expand the sample pool, particularly among investors who may not have been directly accessible to the researcher but were relevant to the study.

While both convenience and snowball sampling are non-probability techniques and may limit the generalizability of findings, they are practical and effective for descriptive research aimed at identifying trends, behaviours, and strategic practices among individual investors.

3.7 DESCRIPTION OF THE POPULATION

A population can be defined as the entire group of individuals or entities that share common characteristics and meet the inclusion criteria of a particular study. In this research, the population consists of individual investors who are engaged in any form of financial investment activity.

The study targets a broad range of investors who actively or passively participates in wealth creation through various investment avenues such as mutual funds, stocks, PPF, gold/silver, real estate, insurance, and other financial instruments.

This includes people from different professional, income, and age backgrounds, such as:

- Students and young earners beginning their investment journey
- Salaried employees investing a part of their monthly income
- Self-employed individuals and business owners managing personal portfolios
- Retired individuals who invest to secure long-term stability

Since there is no central registry or database listing all retail investors in a specific location, estimating the exact size of this population is difficult. The population is dynamic and unorganized, and the number of individuals involved in investing can vary widely based on region, financial literacy, employment status, and economic activity.

For the purpose of this study, individuals who had prior experience with or interest in any form of financial investment were considered part of the target population. The study does not focus on institutional or high-net-worth investors, but rather on everyday individual investors engaged in wealth creation through strategic financial planning.

3.8 SAMPLING UNIT

A sampling unit refers to a single individual or element selected from the larger target population from whom data is collected for analysis. It is the smallest unit that provides information for the study and forms the basis for drawing conclusions.

In the context of this study on strategic investment behaviour and wealth creation, the sampling units consisted of individual investors who are actively or passively involved in financial investment activities. These include people who invest in avenues such as mutual funds, stocks, public provident funds (PPF), gold/silver, real estate, insurance, and other financial instruments.

The selected individuals represent different demographic and economic segments, including students, salaried professionals, self-employed individuals, and retired persons. Each sampling unit provided responses through a structured questionnaire, allowing the researcher to gather data on investment behaviour, planning habits, risk tolerance, financial awareness, and satisfaction with investment returns.

3.9 SAMPLE SIZE

While a larger sample size can often lead to more accurate and generalizable results, it is not always practical to survey the entire target population due to limitations in time, accessibility, and resources.

For this study on Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities, the sample size has been fixed at **200** respondents. These participants were selected based on convenience and referrals, and each one fits the criteria of being an individual investor engaged in any form of financial investment.

This sample size is considered sufficient to observe patterns, analyse behaviour, and draw meaningful conclusions related to the objectives of the study.

3.10 DATA COLLECTION METHOD

The data collection method refers to the systematic process of gathering relevant information from selected respondents to meet the objectives of the study.

For this research on Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities, primary data was collected using a structured questionnaire. The questionnaire was created using Google Forms and circulated digitally through platforms such as email, WhatsApp, and social media. This online distribution method allowed easy access to a broad range of individual investors from diverse backgrounds.

In addition to online sharing, the researcher also visited selected bank branches, including State Bank of India (SBI), HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, and Punjab National Bank (PNB). During these visits, personal interviews were conducted with bank employees and willing customers to explain the purpose of the study and collect their responses. These face-to-face interactions not only improved response accuracy but also helped reach individuals who may not have responded through digital channels.

By combining digital distribution, bank visits, and personal interviews, the researcher was able to collect reliable and diverse data efficiently within a limited timeframe.

3.11 TOOLS FOR ANALYSIS

The data collected through the structured, close-ended questionnaire was analysed using appropriate descriptive statistical tools to fulfil the objectives of the study. Key techniques included percentage analysis, mean (average), and frequency distribution, which facilitated a comprehensive understanding of individual investor behaviour, planning habits, financial awareness, and levels of satisfaction with investment outcomes.

Data processing and analysis were conducted using Microsoft Excel, where built-in functions and pivot tables were employed to organize and interpret the responses. These tools enabled effective categorization of data across various demographic and financial variables such as age, income, risk tolerance, and investment preferences.

To support clearer interpretation, data visualizations—including bar charts, pie charts, and column graphs—were generated. These graphical representations allowed for an insightful comparison of trends related to investment frequency, preferred avenues, planning discipline, and perceived financial satisfaction among respondents.

In addition, to assess the reliability of the Likert scale statements included in the questionnaire (particularly those evaluating attitudes and awareness), Cronbach's Alpha was computed manually using Excel. This statistical test measured the internal consistency of the scale, ensuring the credibility and dependability of the collected data.

3.12 Conclusion

The research methodology applied in this study on wealth creation through strategic investment opportunities has been carefully structured to ensure reliability, accuracy, and relevance to the research objectives. By adopting a descriptive design and quantitative approach, the study effectively captured investment behavior, planning habits, and financial awareness among individual investors in Guwahati.

The use of structured questionnaires allowed for consistent and measurable data collection across a diverse sample. A combination of online surveys and personal interviews—particularly at selected bank branches—enhanced the reach and quality of responses. The sampling methods, which included both convenience and snowball techniques, enabled the researcher to gather meaningful data from 200 individual investors with varying financial backgrounds and risk profiles.

Data analysis using tools such as percentage, mean, and frequency distribution, along with visual representations and reliability testing, provided clear insights into the patterns and trends of strategic investment behavior. Overall, the chosen methodology ensured a comprehensive and practical foundation for understanding how individual investors plan, act, and strategize their financial decisions to achieve long-term wealth creation.

3.13 Expected Outcome

The study is expected to provide insights into the most commonly preferred investment avenues, behavioral patterns, and financial awareness levels among individual investors. It will help identify the key factors influencing wealth creation, such as planning discipline, risk tolerance, and satisfaction with returns. The outcome will also offer practical recommendations for new and beginner investors, enabling them to make better strategic investment decisions. Additionally, the study aims to support efforts in promoting financial literacy and informed investing practices.

CHAPTER–4

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

4.1 INTRODUCTION

The data analysis and interpretation phase of this study on Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities was crucial in uncovering patterns and insights from the responses of individual investors, particularly from Guwahati, Assam. This phase involves the use of statistical tools and graphical methods to examine how individuals approach investment avenues, manage financial planning, tolerate risks, and evaluate satisfaction with their investment returns.

The objective of this phase is to test whether the initial research assumptions hold true and to validate the formulated research objectives. It helps in understanding how strategic investment decisions are influenced by factors such as investment behavior, financial awareness, goal setting, and risk preferences. Additionally, it identifies investor satisfaction levels and explores suggestions that can guide new or beginner investors toward improved wealth creation.

Data were collected using a structured questionnaire, both online and offline, targeting 200 respondents across diverse occupations and income groups. The questionnaire included sections on demographics, investment patterns, attitudes, awareness levels, satisfaction, and suggestions. The collected data were analyzed using Microsoft Excel**,** and the results are presented through bar charts, pie charts, frequency tables, and percentage analysis**.** These interpretations provide a clearer understanding of the wealth creation behavior and investment strategies followed by retail investors in the selected study area.

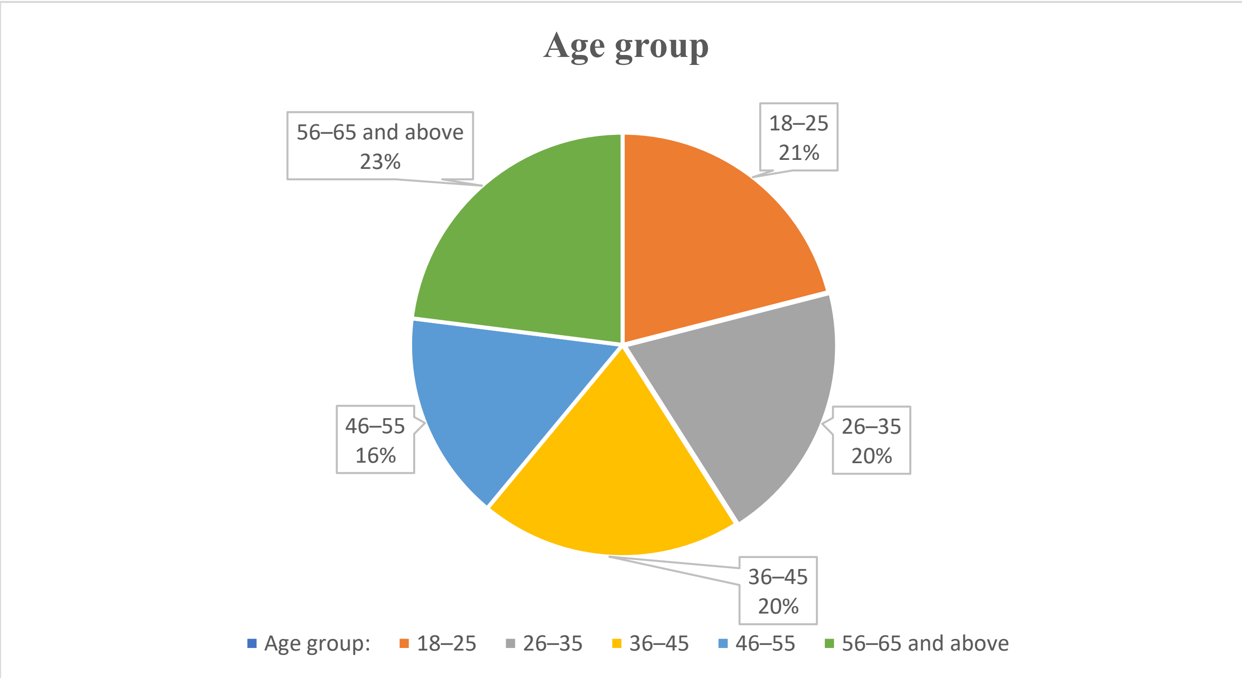
DEMOGRAPHICS OF THE RESPONDENTS

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.1

Table 4.1.1:

Age group:	Respondents	Percentage
18–25	42	21
26–35	40	20
36–45	40	20
46–55	32	16
56–65 and above	46	23
Total	**200**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.1: Pie Chart Showing Age Group of Respondents



Interpretation:

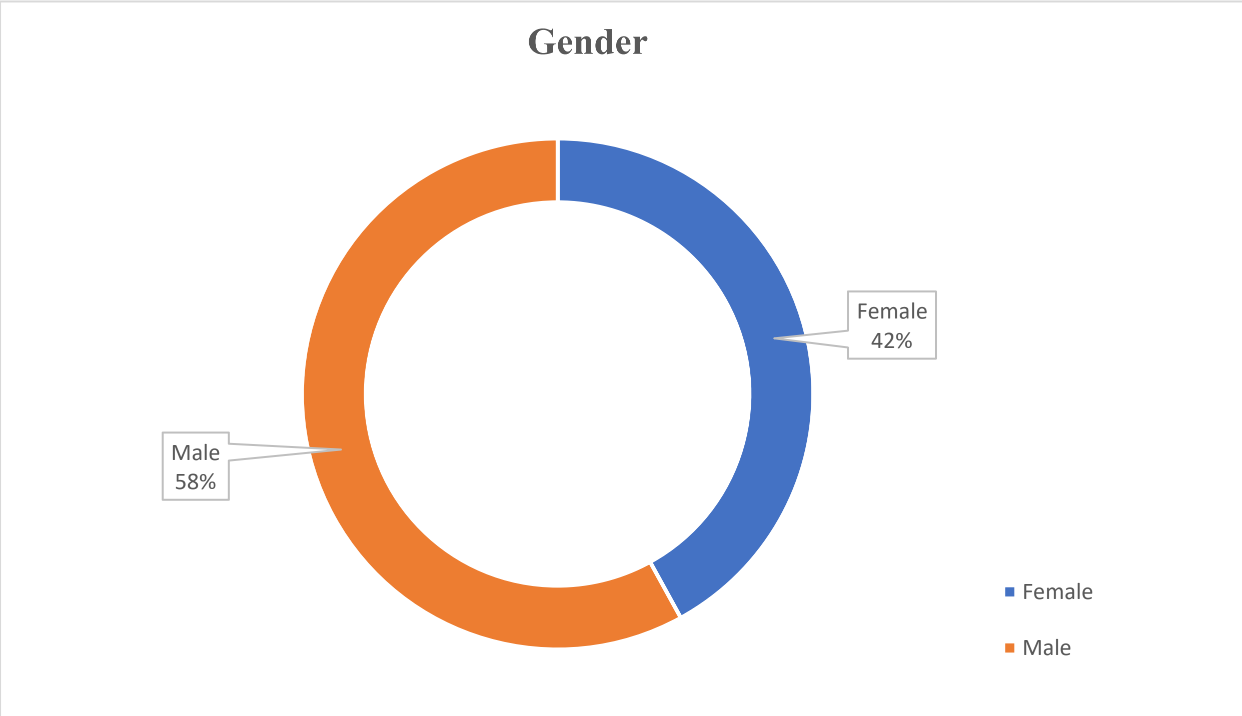
In this study, it was found that 21 per cent of the respondents are between 18–25 years of age, 20 per cent are between 26–35 years of age bracket, another 20 per cent are between 36–45 years of age group, 16 per cent fall within the 46–55 age group, and 23 per cent are 56 years old and above. This indicates that the majority of respondents (23 per cent) belong to the age group of 56–65 and above, followed closely by younger age groups, suggesting a diverse range of age distribution among the participants.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.2

Table 4.1.2:

Gender	Respondents	Percentage
Female	84	42
Male	116	58
Total	**200**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.2: Pie Chart Showing Gender of Respondents



Interpretation:

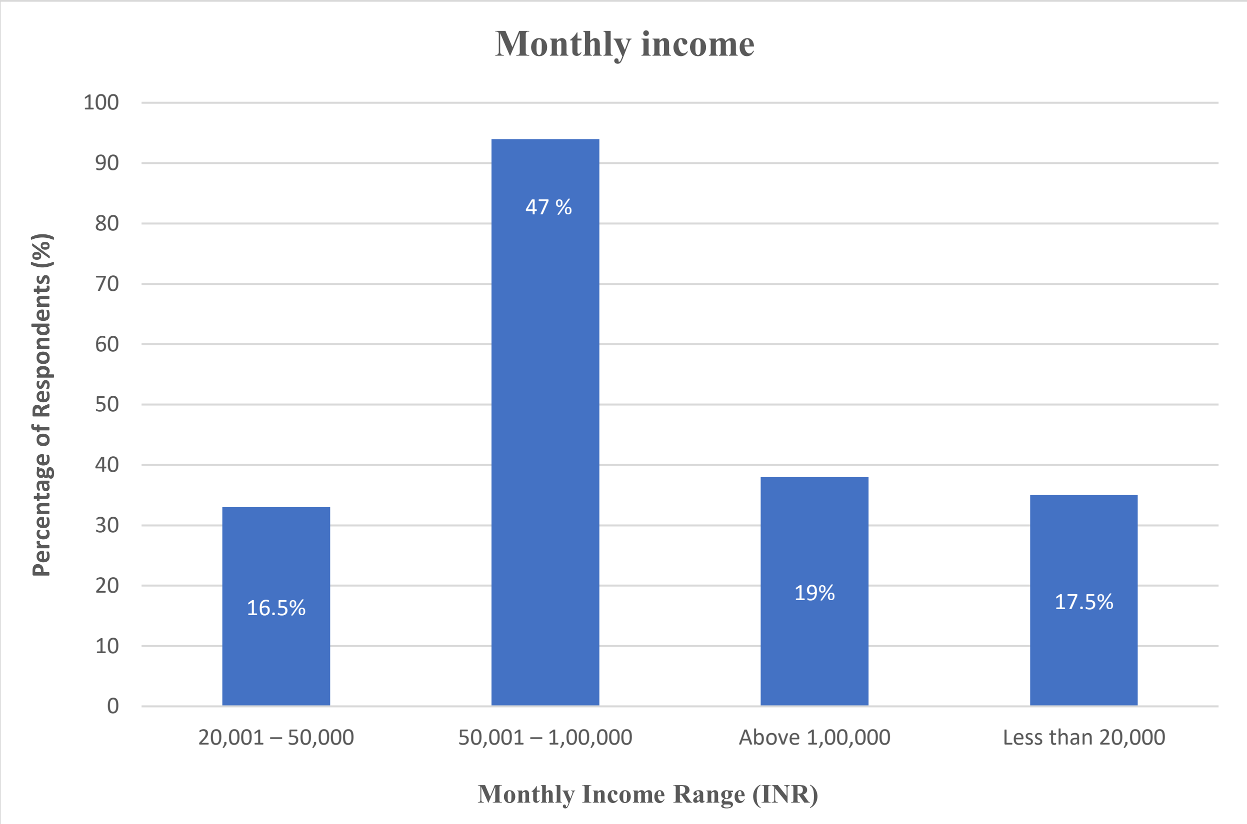
In this study, it was found that 58 per cent of the respondents are male, while 42 per cent are female. This indicates that the majority of the respondents (58 per cent) are male, suggesting a slightly higher participation rate from male individuals in this survey.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.3

Table 4.1.3:

Monthly income (INR):	Respondents	Percentage
Less than 20,000	35	17.5
20,001 – 50,000	33	16.5
50,001 – 1,00,000	94	47
Above 1,00,000	38	19
Total	**200**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.3: Pivot Chart Showing Monthly Income of Respondents (INR)



Interpretation:

In this study, it was found that 17.5 per cent of respondents have a monthly income of less than ₹20,000, 16.5 per cent earn between ₹20,001–₹50,000, 47 per cent earn between ₹50,001–₹1,00,000, and 19 per cent have a monthly income above ₹1,00,000. This indicates that the majority of respondents (47 per cent) fall within the income group of ₹50,001–₹1,00,000, showing that nearly half of the participants belong to a mid-to-upper income segment.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.4

Table 4.1.4:

Occupation:	Respondents	Percentage
Student	37	18.5
Salaried employee	109	54.5
Self-employed / Business	37	18.5
Retired	17	8.5
Total	**200**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.4: Pivot Chart Showing Occupation of Respondents

Interpretation:

In this study, it was found that 18.5 per cent of the respondents are students, 54.5 per cent are salaried employees, 18.5 per cent are self-employed or engaged in business, and 8.5 per cent are retired individuals. This indicates that the majority of respondents (54.5 per cent) are salaried employees, highlighting a strong representation from the working professional segment in the sample.

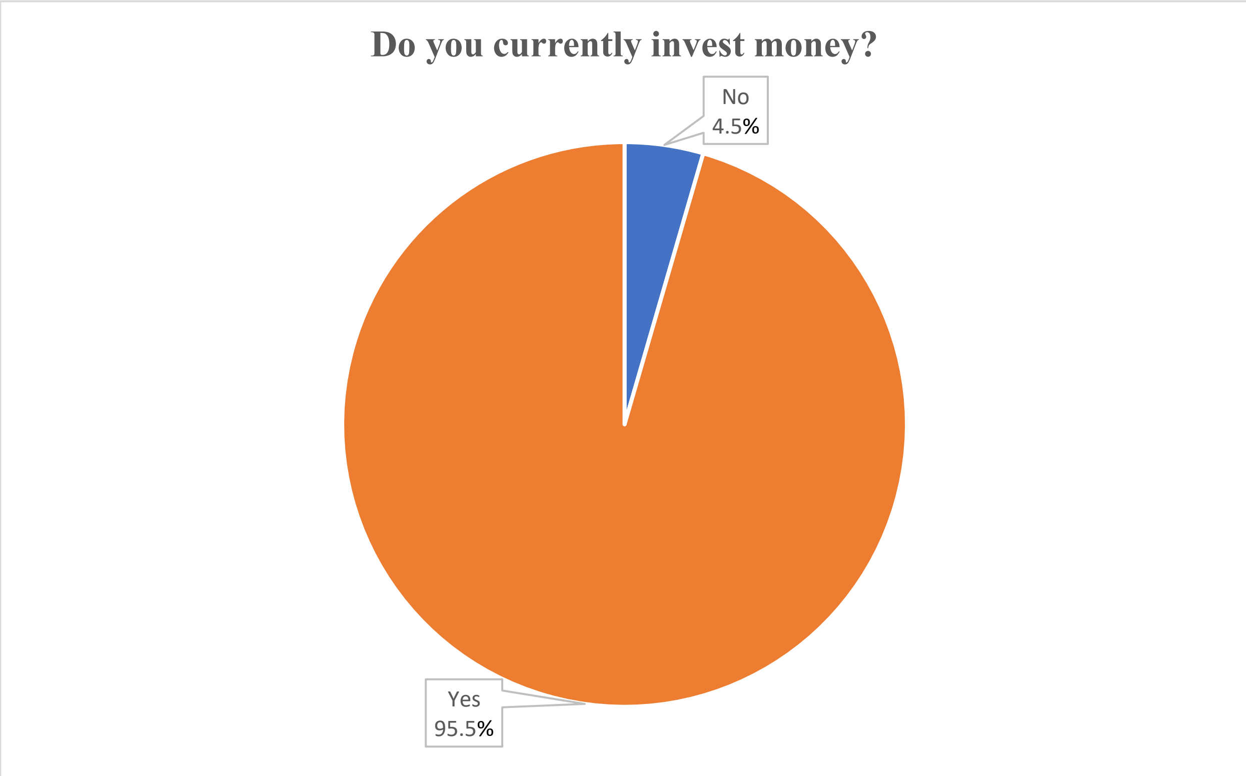
INVESTMENT PROFILE OF THE RESPONDENTS

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.5

Table 4.1.5:

Do you currently invest money?	Respondents	Percentage
No	9	4.5
Yes	191	95.5
Grand Total	**200**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.5: Pie Chart Showing Respondents Currently Investing Money



Interpretation:

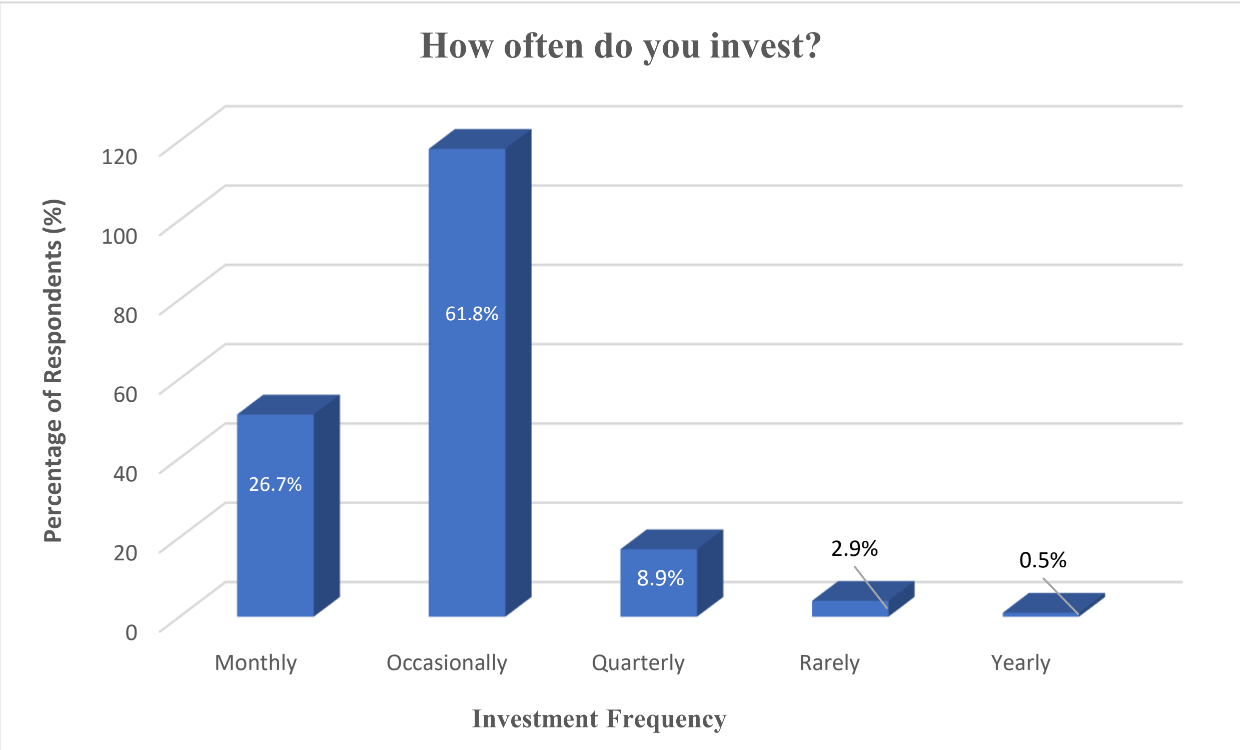
In this study, it was found that 95.5 per cent of the respondents reported that they currently invest money, while only 4.5 per cent stated that they do not. This indicates that the overwhelming majority of respondents (95.5 per cent) are actively engaged in investment activities.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.6

Table 4.1.6:

How often do you invest?	Respondents	Percentage
Monthly	51	26.7
Occasionally	118	61.8
Quarterly	17	8.9
Rarely	4	2.9
Yearly	1	0.5
Grand Total	**191**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.6: Pivot Chart Showing Frequency of Investment by Respondents



Interpretation:

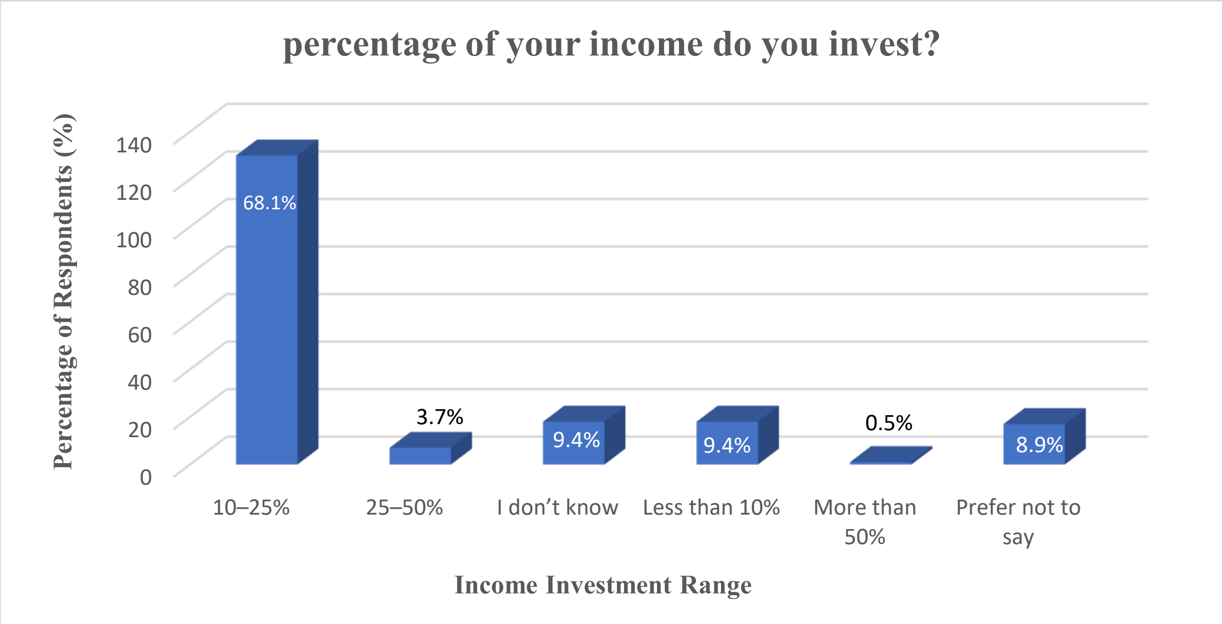
In this study, it was found that 26.7 per cent of respondents invest monthly, 61.8 per cent invest occasionally, 8.9 per cent invest quarterly, 2.9 per cent invest rarely, and 0.5 per cent invest yearly. This indicates that the majority of respondents (61.8 per cent) tend to invest occasionally rather than on a fixed periodic schedule.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.7

Table 4.1.7:

What percentage of your income do you invest?	Respondents	Percentage
I don't know	18	9.4
Less than 10%	18	9.4
10–25%	130	68.1
25–50%	7	3.7
More than 50%	1	0.5
Prefer not to say	17	8.9
Grand Total	**191**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.7: Pivot Chart Showing Percentage of Income Invested by Respondents



Interpretation:

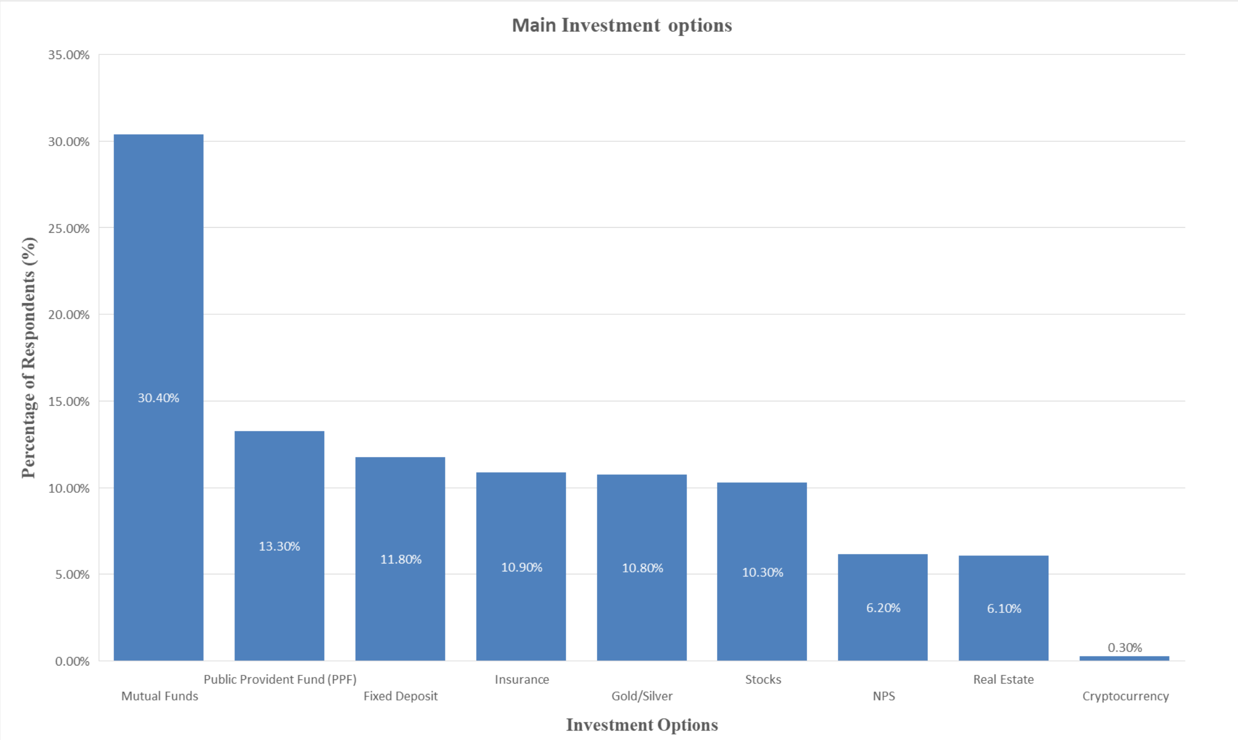
In this study, it was found that 9.4 per cent of respondents reported that they don't know what percentage of their income they invest, another 9.4 per cent invest less than 10 per cent, 68.1 per cent invest between 10–25 per cent, 3.7 per cent invest between 25–50 per cent, 0.5 per cent invest more than 50 per cent, and 8.9 per cent preferred not to disclose. This indicates that the majority of respondents (68.1 per cent) typically invest between 10–25 per cent of their income.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.8

Table 4.1.8:

What are your main investment options?	Frequency	Percentage
Fixed Deposit	70	11.8
Mutual Funds	181	30.4
Stocks	61	10.3
Public Provident Fund (PPF)	79	13.3
Cryptocurrency	2	0.3
Gold/Silver	64	10.8
Real Estate	36	6.1
NPS (national pension scheme)	37	6.2
Insurance (Life, Health, Term, or Other)	65	10.9
Total (times)	**595**	**100**

Figure 4.1.8: Pivot Chart Showing Main Investment Options Chosen by Respondents



Interpretation:

In this study, it was found that 30.4 per cent of the total respondents preferred to invest in Mutual Funds, followed by 13.3 per cent in Public Provident Fund (PPF), and 11.8 per cent in traditional Fixed Deposits. Additionally, 10.9 per cent preferred investing in Insurance products, 10.8 per cent invested in Gold/Silver, and 10.3 per cent in Stocks. A smaller share of respondents selected National Pension Scheme (6.2 per cent), Real Estate (6.1 per cent), and Cryptocurrency, which accounted for just 0.3 per cent. This indicates that while respondents invest across a wide range of options, the majority show a clear preference for Mutual Funds and other relatively safer and traditional investment avenues.

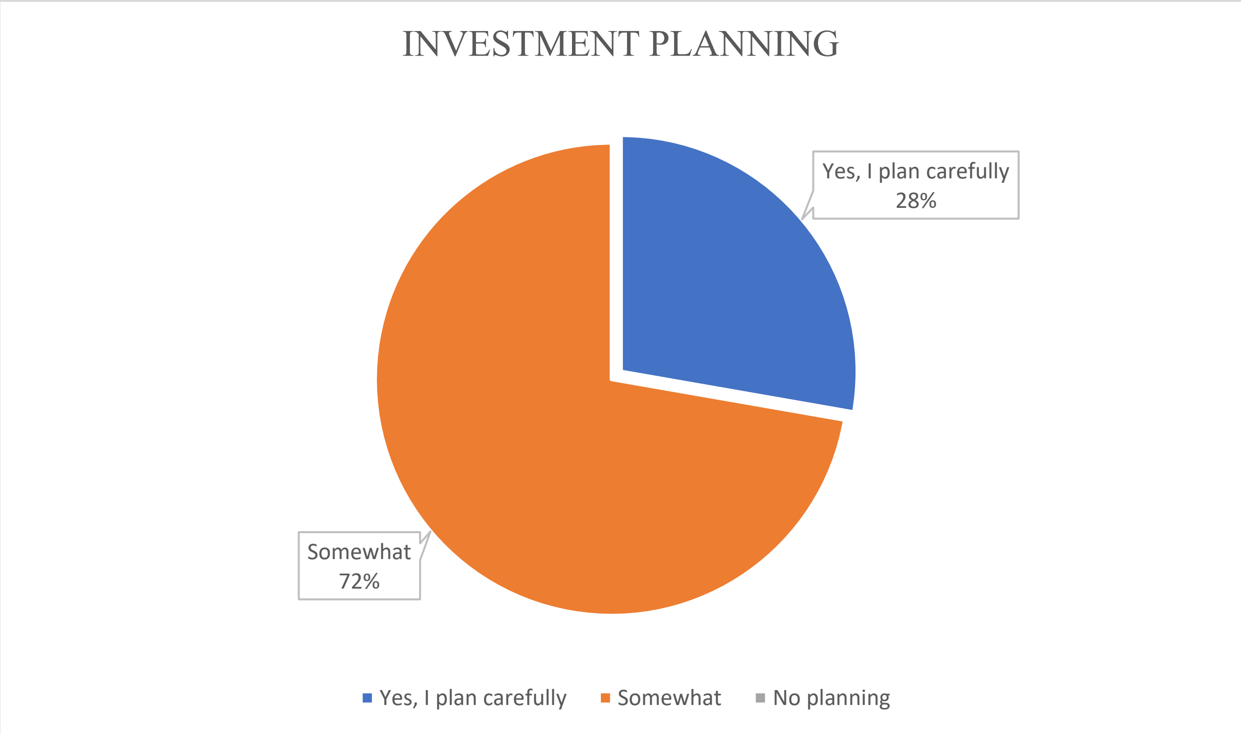
Note: Since this question allowed respondents to choose multiple options, the total frequency (595) reflects the number of times options were selected, not the total number of respondents (191).

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.9

Table 4.1.9:

Do you plan your investments or invest randomly?	Respondents	Percentage
Yes, I plan carefully	53	28
Somewhat	138	72
No planning	0	0
Total	**191**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.9: Pie Chart Showing Investment Planning Habits of Respondents



Interpretation:

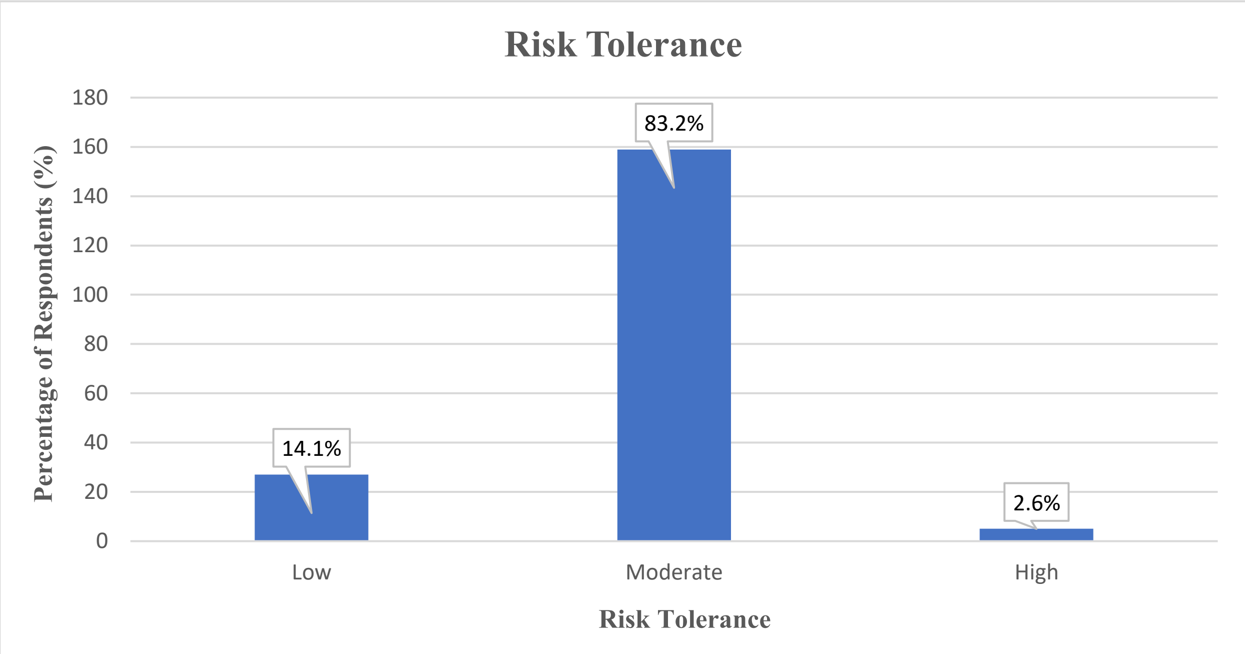
In this study, it was found that 28 per cent of respondents reported that they plan their investments carefully, while 72 per cent stated they do so only somewhat. None of the respondents reported investing without any planning at all. This indicates that although a majority do not plan their investments in detail, almost all respondents apply at least some level of planning to their investment decisions.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.10

Table 4.1.10:

risk tolerance	Respondents	Percentage
Low	27	14.1
Moderate	159	83.2
High	5	2.6
Total	**191**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.10: Pivot Chart Showing Risk Tolerance Level of Respondents



Interpretation:

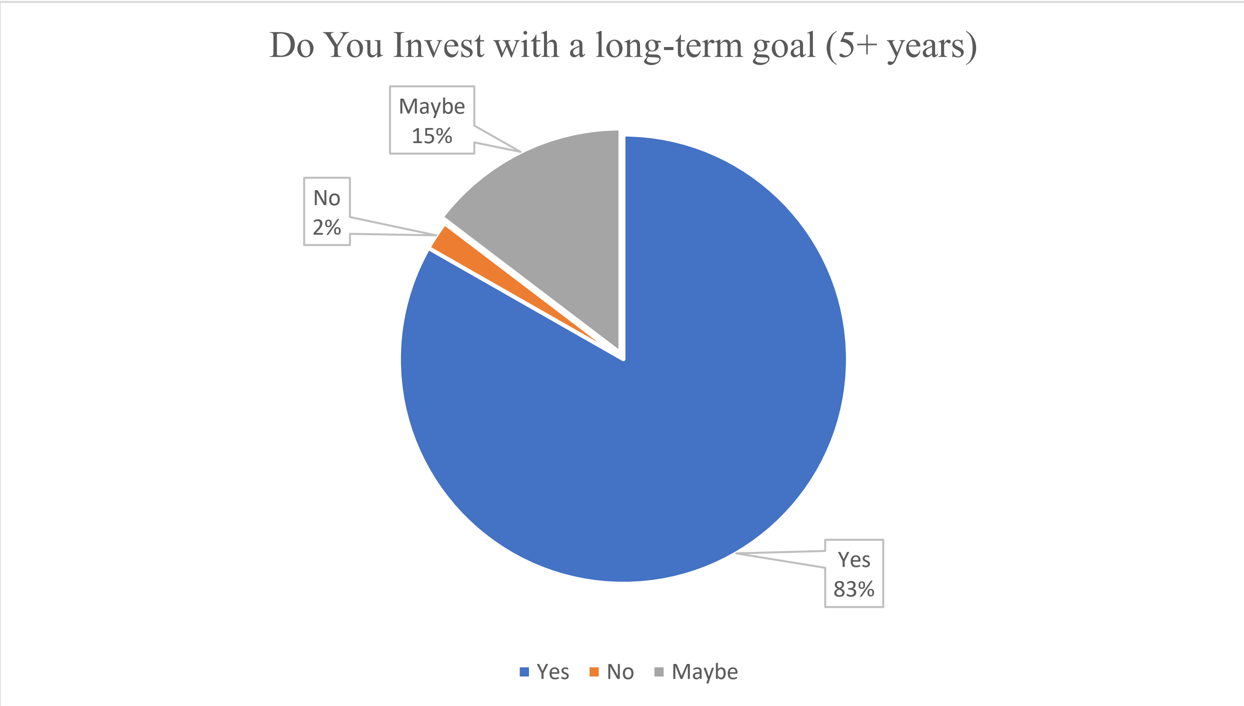
In this study, it was found that 83.2 per cent of respondents have a moderate risk tolerance, 14.1 per cent have a low risk tolerance, and only 2.6 per cent reported a high-risk tolerance. This indicates that the vast majority of respondents (83.2 per cent) prefer to take a balanced approach to risk when making investment decisions.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.11

Table 4.1.11:

Invest with a long-term goal (5+ years)	Respondents	Percentage
Yes	159	83
No	4	2
Maybe	28	15
Total	**191**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.11: Pie Chart Showing Respondents Investing with a Long-Term Goal (5+ Years)



Interpretation:

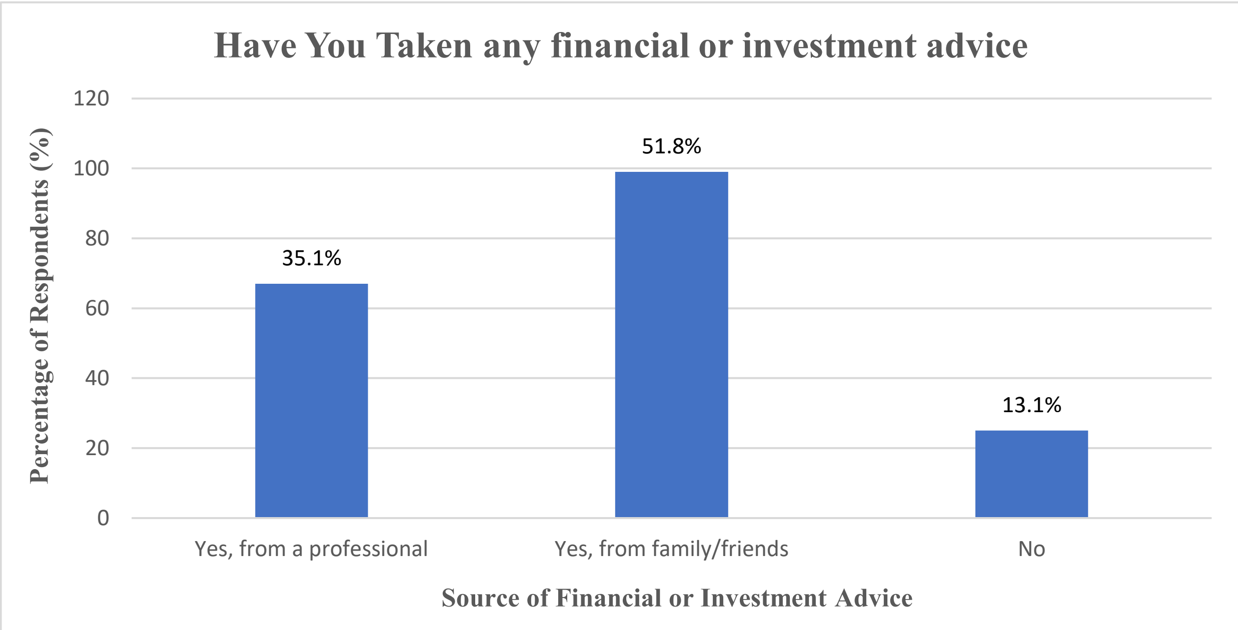
In this study, 83 per cent of respondents said they invest with a long-term goal of over five years, while only 2 per cent said they do not, and 15 per cent were unsure ("maybe"). This indicates that the majority of investors have a clear long-term focus, which is a positive sign for disciplined wealth creation. Long-term investing allows for better compounding and aligns with financial goals like retirement or future planning. However, the 15 per cent who responded "maybe" shows that some investors still lack proper clarity or planning in their investment journey.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.12

Table 4.1.12:

Taken any financial or investment advice?	Respondent	Percentage
Yes, from a professional	67	35.1
Yes, from family/friends	99	51.8
No	25	13.1
Total	**191**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.12: Pivot Chart Showing Sources of Financial or Investment Advice among Respondents



Interpretation:

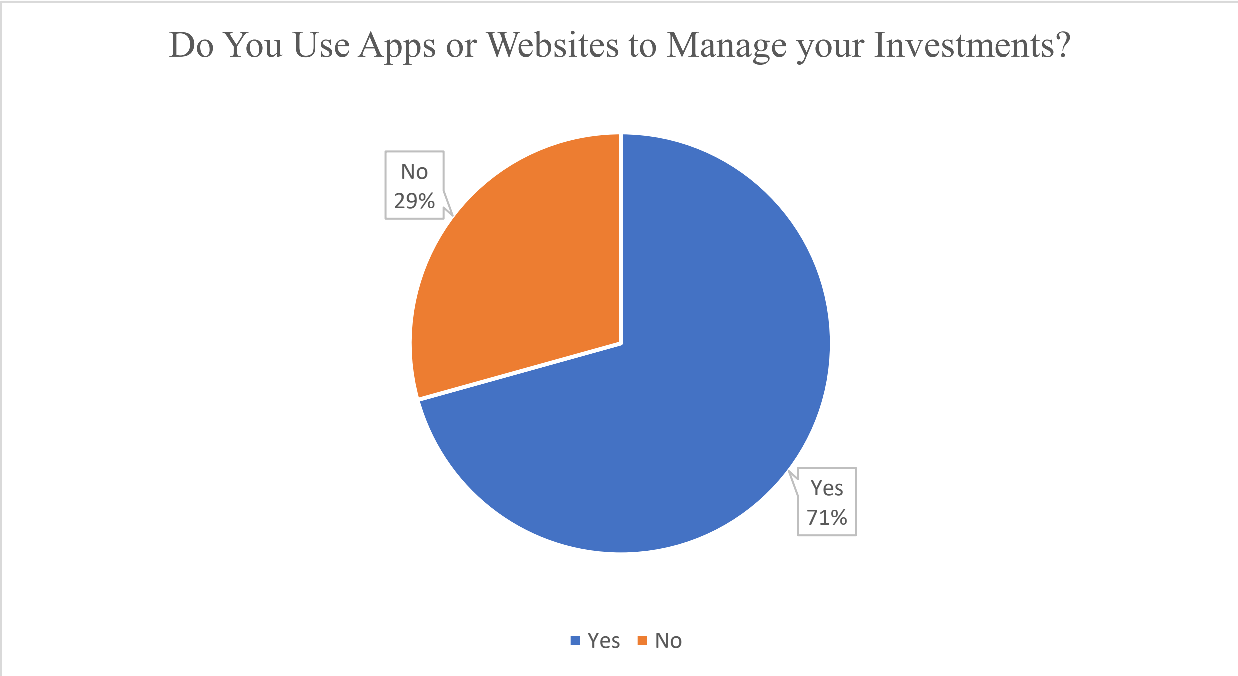
In this study, it was found that 51.8 per cent of respondents have taken financial or investment advice from family or friends, 35.1 per cent have consulted a professional advisor, and 13.1 per cent reported not taking any advice at all. This indicates that while informal advice from family and friends is the most common, a considerable number of respondents also seek guidance from professional sources.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.13

Table 4.1.13:

Do you use apps or websites to manage your investments?	Respondents	Percentage
Yes	135	71
No	56	29
Total	**191**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.13: Pie Chart Showing Respondents Using Apps or Websites to Manage Investments



Interpretation:

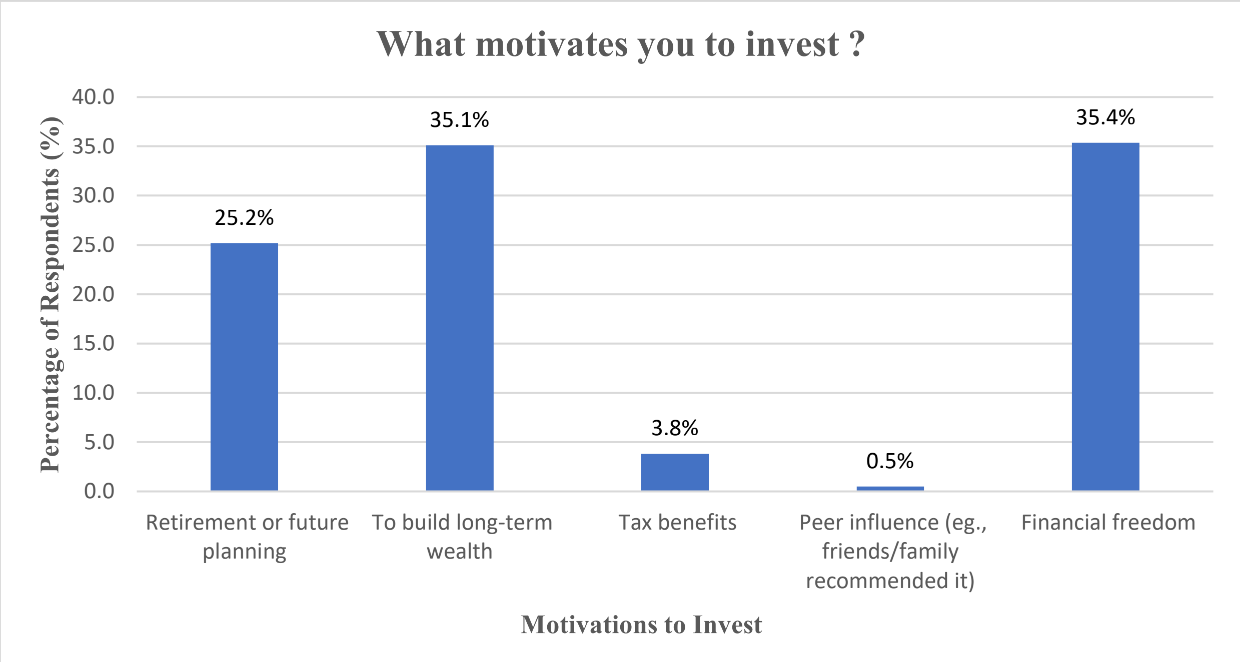
In this study, it was found that 71 per cent of respondents reported using apps or websites to manage their investments, while 29 per cent do not. This indicates that the majority of respondents (71 per cent) rely on digital tools for managing and tracking their investments.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.14

Table 4.1.14:

What motivates you to invest?	Frequency	Percentage
Retirement or future planning	99	25.2
To build long-term wealth	138	35.1
Tax benefits	15	3.8
Peer influence (e.g. friends/family recommended it)	2	0.5
Financial freedom	139	35.4
Total (times)	**393**	**100**

Figure 4.1.14: Pivot Chart Showing Key Motivations for Investing among Respondents



Interpretation:

In this study, it was found that financial freedom was the top motivation to invest, accounting for 35.4 per cent of the total responses, followed closely by building long-term wealth at 35.1 per cent. Retirement or future planning was also a significant motivator, with 25.2 per cent of selections. On the other hand, only 3.8 per cent of responses cited tax benefits, and a very small 0.5 per cent mentioned peer influence (such as suggestions from friends or family).

This shows that most investors are driven by internal, long-term financial goals, such as becoming financially independent or growing wealth steadily over time, rather than being influenced by short-term tax savings or external pressure. These motivations reflect a more mature and self-driven investment mindset, which is beneficial for long-term wealth creation.

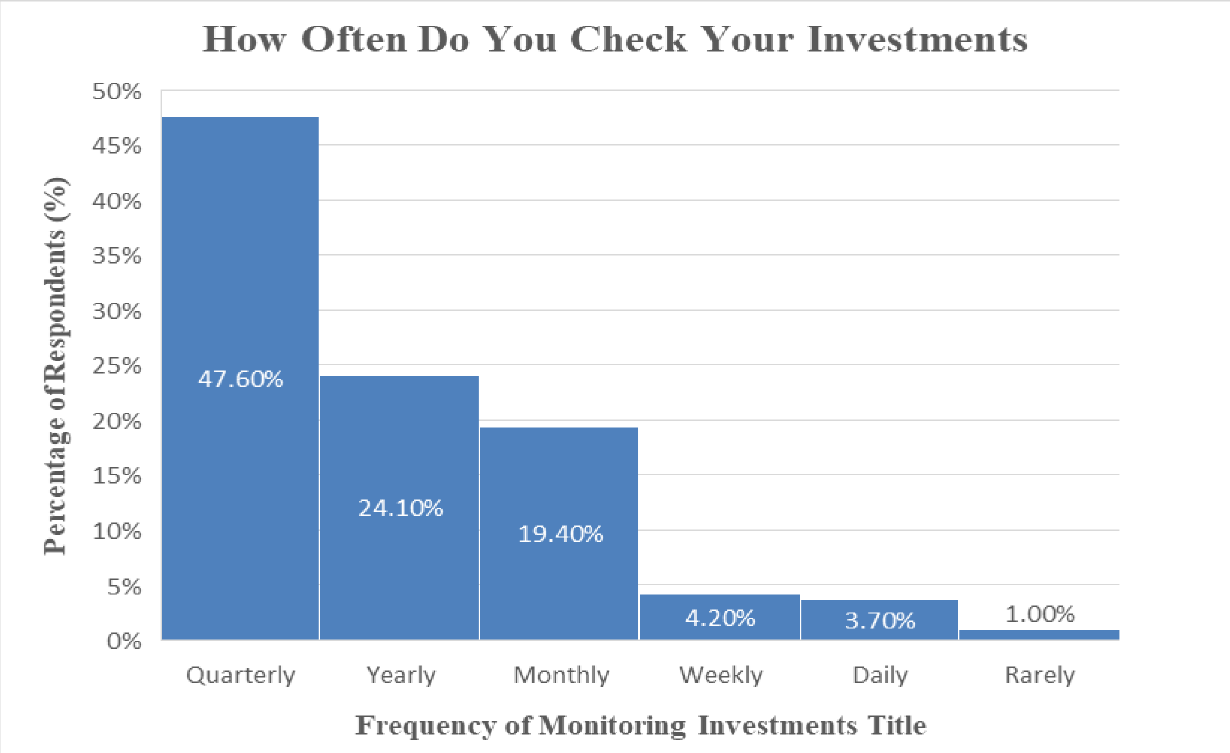
It is also important to note that this was a multiple-choice question, so respondents could select more than one reason. The total number of responses (393) is higher than the number of participants (191), which highlights that most investors are motivated by a combination of financial goals, not just a single factor.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.15

Table 4.1.15:

How often do you check/monitor your investments	Respondents	Percentage
Daily	7	3.7
Weekly	8	4.2
Monthly	37	19.4
Quarterly	91	47.6
Yearly	46	24.1
Rarely	2	1
Total	**191**	**100.00**

Figure 4.1.15: Pivot Chart Showing Frequency of Monitoring Investments by Respondents



Interpretation:

In this study, it was observed that 47.6 per cent of respondents monitored their investments on a quarterly basis, making it the most common frequency of review. This was followed by 24.1 per cent who checked their investments yearly, and 19.4 per cent who checked their investments monthly. A smaller group, 4.2 per cent, reviewed their portfolios weekly, and only 3.7 per cent monitored their investments daily. Notably, just 1 per cent of respondents reported that they rarely monitored their investments.

These findings indicated that most investors preferred to review their portfolios at moderate intervals, such as quarterly or yearly, rather than very frequently. This behaviour reflected a long-term investment mindset, where individuals did not react to short-term market fluctuations. However, the fact that only a small number monitored their portfolios daily or weekly also showed that very active portfolio management or trading was uncommon among the respondents. The minimal number of people who rarely checked their investments suggested that most investors were at least somewhat engaged in tracking their financial performance, which was a positive sign of financial awareness and responsibility.

CRONBACH'S ALPHA TEST

(INTRODUCTION)

4.1.16 Introduction

Cronbach's Alpha is a commonly used statistical tool that helps measure the internal consistency or reliability of a group of related items in a questionnaire. In simple terms, it checks whether a set of statements or questions are all measuring the same underlying concept. The Alpha value ranges from 0 to 1, where a value above 0.70 is considered acceptable for academic research, and values above 0.80 indicate a high level of consistency among the items. A high Cronbach's Alpha means that the items are closely related and reliable for drawing meaningful conclusions.

In this research study, a structured questionnaire was used to assess how individual investors think and behave in relation to wealth creation and strategic investments. A specific section of the questionnaire (Section C: Attitudes and Knowledge) consisted of 15 Likert-scale statements that were designed to capture behavioural and psychological aspects of investors. These statements focused on various areas such as:

- Understanding of risk and return
- Preference for long-term over short-term investing
- Confidence in managing own investments
- Investment decision-making habits
- Portfolio review and rebalancing
- Setting clear financial goals
- Openness to learning about smart investing
- Trust in strategic investment over simple saving

Because these traits represent complex investor behaviour and cannot be measured through a single question, it was important to test the reliability of the grouped statements. Cronbach's Alpha was applied to ensure that all the items used to assess investor behaviour and awareness were consistent and functioned well as a single scale.

The calculated Cronbach's Alpha value of 0.8269 indicates a strong level of internal consistency. This suggests that the responses were stable and the questionnaire was well-structured for analysing investor attitudes, confidence, and planning habits.

Overall, the reliability result strengthens the credibility of the data and confirms that the Likert-scale items were effective in capturing the behavioural patterns and strategic mindset of investors toward long-term wealth creation.

<u>FORMULA:</u> $\boldsymbol{\alpha = \left(\frac{k}{k-1}\right)\left(\frac{S_y^2 - \sum s_i^2}{s_y^2}\right)}$

Where:

$\boldsymbol{\alpha}$ = Cronbach's Alpha (reliability coefficient)

k = Number of items (questions/statements)

$\boldsymbol{s_y^2}$ = Variance of the total score across all items

$\boldsymbol{\sum s_i^2}$ = Sum of variances of each individual item

4.1.17 Major Findings

Likert-scale items in the questionnaire were carefully designed to measure various psychological and behavioural aspects of wealth creation through strategic investment opportunities, such as:

1. Awareness of investment risks
2. Preference for long-term investment over short-term trading
3. Regular review and rebalancing of portfolio
4. Setting clear financial goals for each investment
5. Confidence in managing own investments
6. Willingness to learn more about smart investing
7. Making investment decisions based on research and facts rather than emotions
8. Belief that strategic investing is better than just saving in a bank
9. Reading and following articles or content related to investment strategies
10. Investing in options that provide both safety and growth
11. Satisfaction with current investment returns
12. Having a clear strategy for wealth creation
13. Avoiding high-risk investments without proper research

Cronbach's Alpha Calculation

Table 4.1.16

Total Variance	45.30416
K	15
Sum of Variance	10.33772
Cronbach Alpha	0.826945

In this study, data was gathered using a structured questionnaire with statements designed to measure respondents' attitudes, behaviours, and confidence toward strategic investing. Each statement was rated on a five-point Likert scale, covering topics like risk awareness, preference for long-term strategies, portfolio review habits, goal setting, and openness to learning about investing.

The results show that most respondents have a moderate to strong positive attitude toward strategic investing. Many agreed with statements like "I understand the difference between saving and investing" and "I regularly read articles related to investment strategies," reflecting awareness of financial principles, disciplined long-term thinking, and an interest in continuous learning. High agreement on wanting to learn more about smart investing further highlights a growth-oriented mindset among participants.

A Cronbach's Alpha reliability test was conducted to check the consistency of the responses, resulting in a value of 0.826945, which indicates a high level of internal consistency and reliability. Overall, the findings suggest that while respondents already show responsible investment behaviours and strategic thinking, there remains potential to further enhance their knowledge and practices through financial education, advanced training, or advisory support to help achieve sustained wealth creation.

4.1.18 Conclusion

The Cronbach's Alpha test conducted in this study yielded a value of **0.826945**, which indicates a **high level of internal consistency** among the 15 Likert-scale statements used to measure investor attitudes and behavioural traits. This strong alpha score suggests that the items were closely related and effectively captured a unified concept — specifically, the psychological and strategic dimensions of individual investment behaviour.

This result confirms that respondents interpreted the statements in a consistent manner and responded with reliability across similar themes, such as goal setting, risk awareness, confidence in managing investments, and openness to learning. The scale functioned well as a cohesive tool for assessing behavioural tendencies, and the responses it generated can be considered statistically dependable.

By achieving a Cronbach's Alpha above the commonly accepted threshold of 0.826945, the research confirms that the questionnaire was well-structured, and the data collected through it are both credible and stable for understanding the attitudes and mindset of investors toward wealth creation and strategic financial planning.

CHI-SQUARE TEST

(INTRODUCTION)

4.1.19 Introduction

The Chi-Square Test of Independence is a statistical tool used to find out whether two different groups or variables are related to each other. It works by comparing the observed results (what we actually see in the data) with the expected results (what we would expect if there was no relationship). If the difference between these two is large enough, we conclude that the two factors are likely connected.

This test is especially useful when we deal with categorical data, such as responses collected using a 5-point Likert scale (Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree). It allows us to check for possible associations between behaviours, attitudes, and outcomes among respondents.

The main purpose of using the Chi-Square Test in this Research was to see whether there is a significant connection between certain behavioural and psychological aspects of investors. These were measured using Likert-scale statements (ranging from Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree) from **Section C: Attitudes and Knowledge of the questionnaire.**

By applying the Chi-Square test, the goal was to find out whether investors' beliefs, awareness, or strategies were related to their actual behaviour or satisfaction levels. This helps us understand whether thinking in a certain way leads to better outcomes or smarter investment choices.

In this study, the Chi-Square Test was used to examine whether certain psychological and behavioural traits of investors are connected to their real investment practices or levels of satisfaction. All the statements used for this analysis were taken from Section C (Attitudes and Knowledge) of the structured questionnaire.

To study this in detail, three sets of variable pairs were tested**:**

- **Set 1** – Whether having a clear strategy for wealth creation is related to being satisfied with current investment returns.
- **Set 2** – Whether believing that strategic investing is better than simple saving is related to actually having a clear investment strategy.
- **Set 3 –** Whether awareness of investment risks is related to investing in options that offer both safety and growth.

Each of these sets represents a possible relationship between what investors think or believe and what they actually do in practice. The Chi-Square Test was conducted on all three sets using responses from the full group of participants. However, in Set 1, additional steps were taken to ensure the findings were more balanced and unbiased.

For Set 1 only, the Chi-Square Test was conducted separately for three distinct groups of respondents:

- Salaried respondents,
- Non-salaried respondents, and
- All respondents combined (i.e., both salaried and non-salaried together).

This analysis was conducted to understand whether having a clear investment strategy is linked to how satisfied individuals feel about their current investment returns. Since investment behavior can vary depending on one's employment status, the Chi-Square Test for Set 1 was carried out in three stages: first for salaried respondents, then for non-salaried respondents, and finally for all participants combined.

The main reason for this group-wise testing was to observe if there are any noticeable differences in investment patterns and satisfaction levels between salaried and non-salaried individuals. For example, salaried people generally have a regular income and may follow a more structured investment approach, while others—such as students, retirees, or business owners—might follow different financial habits.

Additionally, the sample used in this study had a higher number of salaried individuals compared to other occupational groups. This created a slight imbalance in the overall data. To avoid this skew from influencing the results, the group-wise testing helped ensure that the findings were fair and representative of each segment. It also allowed the study to examine whether the relationship between strategy and satisfaction holds true across different categories of investors.

Once the separate analyses were completed, a combined test was also performed to understand the general pattern across the entire respondent base. This comparison helped highlight whether the overall trend was consistent with the individual group findings.

In contrast, for **Set 2** and **Set 3**, the Chi-Square Test was applied only to the combined responses of all participants.

- **Set 2** focused on testing whether those who believe that strategic investing is better than just saving actually follow through by having a strategy in place.
- **Set 3** examined whether respondents who are aware of investment risks also choose investment options that balance both safety and growth.

These combined analyses helped the study explore common behavioural trends and assess how strongly beliefs and awareness are reflected in actual financial decisions. Overall, this structured testing approach added depth and clarity to the research, allowing for a better understanding of how different types of investors think and act when it comes to long-term wealth creation.

FORMULA:

$$\boldsymbol{X_c^2 = \Sigma \frac{(O_i - E_i)^2}{E_i}}$$

Where:

$\boldsymbol{X_c^2}$ = Chi-Square test statistic

$\boldsymbol{O_i}$ = Observed frequency in category *i*

$\boldsymbol{E_i}$ = Expected frequency in category *i*

$\boldsymbol{\Sigma}$ = Summation over all categories

4.1.20 Chi-Square Test on Strategy with Reference to Satisfaction

A. (Salaried Respondents)

Variable 1 - I have a clear strategy for wealth creation

Variable 2 - I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments

- **Null Hypothesis (H_0):** There is no significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with the returns from current investments among salaried respondents.
- **Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):** There is a significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with the returns from current investments among salaried respondents.

Table 4.1.17

Observed (O)	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	row total
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation	0	6	44	50	7	**107**
I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments	**1**	**7**	**44**	**40**	15	**107**
column total	**1**	**13**	**88**	**90**	**22**	**214**
Expected (E)	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**row total**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation	0.5	6.5	44	45	11	**107**
I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments	0.5	6.5	44	45	11	**107**
column total	**1**	**13**	**88**	**90**	**22**	**214**
(O-E) ^2/E	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**row total**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation	0.5	0.038462	0	0.555556	1.454545455	2.548563
I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments	0.5	0.038462	0	0.555556	1.454545455	2.548563
column total	**1**	**0.076923**	**0**	**1.111111**	**2.909090909**	**5.097125**

To test this, we used the Chi-square test of independence.

- **Calculated Chi-square statistic (x^2):** ≈ 5.10
- **Degrees of freedom (df):** 4
- **Level of significance (α):** 0.05
- **p-value:** ≈ 0.276

  Since the p-value (≈ 0.276) is greater than the significance level (0.05), we fail to reject the null hypothesis.

Findings:

This means that, based on the sample data collected from salaried respondents:

- There is no statistically significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with the returns from current investments.
- Even if salaried respondents have a strategy, it does not necessarily mean they feel more satisfied with their current investment returns.

B. (Non-Salaried Respondents)

Variable 1 - I have a clear strategy for wealth creation

Variable 2 - I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments

- **Null Hypothesis (H_0):** There is no significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with the returns from current investments among non-salaried respondents.
- **Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):** There is a significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with the returns from current investments among non-salaried respondents.

Table 4.1.18

Observed (O)	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	row total
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation	0	14	33	27	10	**84**
I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments	**1**	**8**	**27**	**40**	8	**84**
column total	**1**	**22**	**60**	**67**	**18**	**168**
Expected (E)	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**row total**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation	0.5	11	30	33.5	9	84
I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments	0.5	11	30	33.5	9	84
column total	1	22	60	67	18	168
(O-E)^2/E	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**row total**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation	0.5	0.818182	0.3	1.261194	0.111111111	2.990487
I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments	0.5	0.818182	0.3	1.261194	0.111111111	2.990487
column total	**1**	**1.636364**	**0.6**	**2.522388**	**0.222222222**	**5.980974**

To test this, we used the Chi-square test of independence.

- **Calculated Chi-square statistic (x^2):** ≈ 5.98
- **Degrees of freedom (df):** 4
- **Level of significance (α):** 0.05

- **p-value:** ≈ 0.200

  Since the p-value (~0.200) is greater than the significance level (0.05), we fail to reject the null hypothesis.

  Findings:

  This means that, based on the sample data collected among non-salaried respondents:

- There is no statistically significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with current investment returns.
- Even if non-salaried respondents say they have a strategy for wealth creation, it doesn't necessarily mean they feel more satisfied with the returns they get from their current investments

C. (Both Salaried & Non-Salaried Respondents)

Variable 1 - I have a clear strategy for wealth creation.

Variable 2 - I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments.

- **Null Hypothesis (H_0):** There is no significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with the returns from current investments.
- **Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):** There is a significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with the returns from current investments.

Table 4.1.19

Observed (O)	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**row total**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation	0	20	77	77	17	**191**
I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments.	2	15	71	80	23	**191**
column total	**2**	**35**	**148**	**157**	**40**	**382**
Expected (E)	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**row total**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation	1	17.5	74	78.5	20	**191**
I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments.	1	17.5	74	78.5	20	**191**
column total	**2**	**35**	**148**	**157**	**40**	**382**
(O-E) ^2/E	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**row total**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation	1	0.357143	0.121622	0.028662	0.45	1.957427
I am satisfied with the returns I get from my current investments.	1	0.357143	0.121622	0.028662	0.45	1.957427
column total	2	0.714286	0.243243	0.057325	0.9	**3.914854**

To test this, we used the Chi-square test of independence.

- **Calculated Chi-square statistic (x^2):** ≈ 3.91
- **Degrees of freedom (df):** 4

- **Level of significance (α):** 0.05
- **p-value:** ≈ 0.418

Since the p-value (0.418) is greater than the significance level (0.05), we fail to reject the null hypothesis.

Findings:

This means that, based on the sample data collected:

- There is no statistically significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with the returns from current investments.
- Even if respondents have a strategy for wealth creation, it does not necessarily mean they are more satisfied with their current investment returns.

To ensure the reliability of this hypothesis test, the analysis was carried out separately for salaried and non-salaried respondents. Since salaried respondents made up a larger portion of the sample, there was a possibility that their responses could disproportionately influence the overall results. By comparing the results of the salaried group, non-salaried group, and the combined data, we ensured that the final conclusions are balanced and not affected by overrepresentation of any single category.

4.1.21 Chi-Square Test on Strategic Belief

Variable 1 - I believe strategic investing is better than just saving in a bank.

Variable 2 - I have a clear strategy for wealth creation.

- **Null Hypothesis (H_0):** There is no significant relationship between believing that strategic investing is better than saving in a bank and having a clear strategy for wealth creation.
- **Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):** There is a significant relationship between believing that strategic investing is better than saving in a bank and having a clear strategy for wealth creation.

Table 4.1.20

Observed (O)	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	row total
I believe strategic investing is better than just saving in a bank	1	14	80	81	15	**191**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation.	0	20	77	77	17	**191**
column total	**1**	**34**	**157**	**158**	**32**	**382**
Expected (e)	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**Row Total**
I believe strategic investing is better than just saving in a bank	0.5	17	78.5	79	16	**191**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation.	0.5	17	78.5	79	16	**191**
Column Total	**1**	**34**	**157**	**158**	**32**	**382**
(O-E) ^2/E	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**Row Total**
I believe strategic investing is better than just saving in a bank	0.5	0.529412	0.0286624	0.050633	0.0625	**1.171207**
I have a clear strategy for wealth creation.	0.5	0.529412	0.0286624	0.050633	0.0625	**1.171207**
Column Total	1	1.058824	0.0573248	0.101266	0.125	**2.342414**

To test this, we used the Chi-square test of independence.

Calculated Chi-square statistic (x^2): ≈ 2.34

Degrees of freedom (df): 4

Level of significance (α): 0.05

p-value: ≈ 0.673

Since the p-value (0.673) is greater than the significance level (0.05), we fail to reject the null hypothesis.

Findings-

This means that, based on the sample data collected:

- There is no statistically significant relationship between respondents believing that strategic investing is better than saving in a bank and them having a clear wealth creation strategy.
- People's belief in strategic investing doesn't necessarily mean they already have a concrete plan for wealth creation.

4.1.22 Chi-Square Test on Awareness with Reference to Balanced investing

Variable 1 - I am aware of the risks in the investment options I choose.

Variable 2 - I invest in options that give both safety and growth.

- **Null Hypothesis (H_0):** There is no significant relationship between being aware of the risks in investment options and investing in options that give both safety and growth.
- **Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):** There is a significant relationship between being aware of the risks in investment options and investing in options that give both safety and growth.

Table 4.1.21

Observed (O)	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	row total
I am aware of the risks in the investment options I choose	6	8	83	73	21	**191**
I invest in options that give both safety and growth.	1	19	74	78	19	**191**
column total	**7**	**27**	**157**	**151**	**40**	**382**
Expected (E)	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**row total**
I am aware of the risks in the investment options I choose	3.5	13.5	78.5	75.5	20	191
I invest in options that give both safety and growth.	3.5	13.5	78.5	75.5	20	191
column total	7	27	157	151	40	382
(O-E) ^2/E	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**	**row total**
I am aware of the risks in the investment options I choose	1.785714286	2.240741	0.257962	0.082781	0.05	4.417198
I invest in options that give both safety and growth.	1.785714286	2.240741	0.257962	0.082781	0.05	4.417198
column total	3.571428571	4.481481	0.515924	0.165563	0.1	**8.834397**

To test this, we used the Chi-square test of independence.

- **Calculated Chi-square statistic (x^2):** ≈ 8.83
- **Degrees of freedom (df):** 4
- **Level of significance (α):** 0.05
- **p-value:** ≈ 0.065

Since the p-value (0.065) is greater than the significance level (0.05), we fail to reject the null hypothesis.

Findings:

This means that, based on the sample data collected:

- There is no statistically significant relationship between being aware of the risks in investment options and actually investing in options that balance safety and growth.
- Even if respondents are aware of investment risks, it does not necessarily mean they invest in a balanced way (safety + growth).

4.1.23 Outcome of the Chi-Square Analysis

After conducting the Chi-Square Test on the three selected sets of investor attitudes and behaviors, the following outcomes were observed:

- **Set 1 (Strategy with Reference to Satisfaction):**
  - The test was performed separately on salaried respondents**,** non-salaried respondents**,** and all respondents combined**.**
  - In all three cases, the results showed no statistically significant relationship between having a clear strategy for wealth creation and being satisfied with current investment returns.
  - This means that even though many investors reported having a strategy, it did not directly correlate with how satisfied they were with their investment outcomes.
- **Set 2 (Belief in Strategic Investing with Reference to Having a Strategy):**
  - This test examined whether people who believe that strategic investing is better than just saving in a bank actually have a clear strategy themselves.
  - The result showed no significant relationship**,** indicating that belief alone doesn't guarantee action. Some respondents may support strategic investing in theory but haven't applied it in practice.
- **Set 3 (Risk Awareness with Reference to Balanced Investing):**
  - This test assessed whether respondents who are aware of investment risks are also choosing investments that offer both safety and growth.
  - The result was not statistically significant, suggesting that even when individuals understand investment risks, it doesn't always reflect in their actual investment behavior.

4.1.24 Conclusion

The Chi-Square analysis in this study was conducted to explore possible relationships between key psychological traits of investors and their real-world financial behaviours. While the aim was to understand whether awareness and beliefs influence smarter or more strategic decision-making, the results revealed an important insight:

Across all three tested sets, no statistically significant relationships were found between the paired variables. This suggests that having knowledge, belief, or awareness alone is not always enough to influence behavior or satisfaction**.**

In **Set 1**, even though many respondents had a strategy, this didn't guarantee satisfaction with their investment returns. This could be due to several factors — such as poor strategy execution, market risks, or unrealistic expectations — that lie outside the planning phase.

In **Set 2**, the lack of relationship between belief in strategic investing and actually having a plan highlights a gap between what people believe and what they do. While many may support long-term planning in theory, not everyone converts that belief into a proper financial roadmap.

In **Set 3**, even though respondents claimed to be aware of investment risks, this awareness did not always translate into choosing balanced investment options. This suggests that while financial literacy is necessary, it may not be sufficient to drive responsible action unless combined with motivation, discipline, or external guidance.

In summary, the Chi-Square test findings emphasize the need for stronger investor education programs — not only to build awareness and belief, but also to help investors practically apply what they know. Encouraging disciplined execution, timely reviews, and action-oriented strategies may help bridge the gap between knowledge and outcome, leading to more meaningful wealth creation over time.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.25

Table 4.1.22:

Category	Frequency	Percentage
Very Satisfied	14	7.3
Satisfied	162	84.8
Neutral	14	7.3
Dissatisfied	1	0.5
Very Dissatisfied	0	0
Total	191	100.0

Figure 4.1.20: Bar Chart Showing Respondents' Satisfaction Level with Current Investment Returns

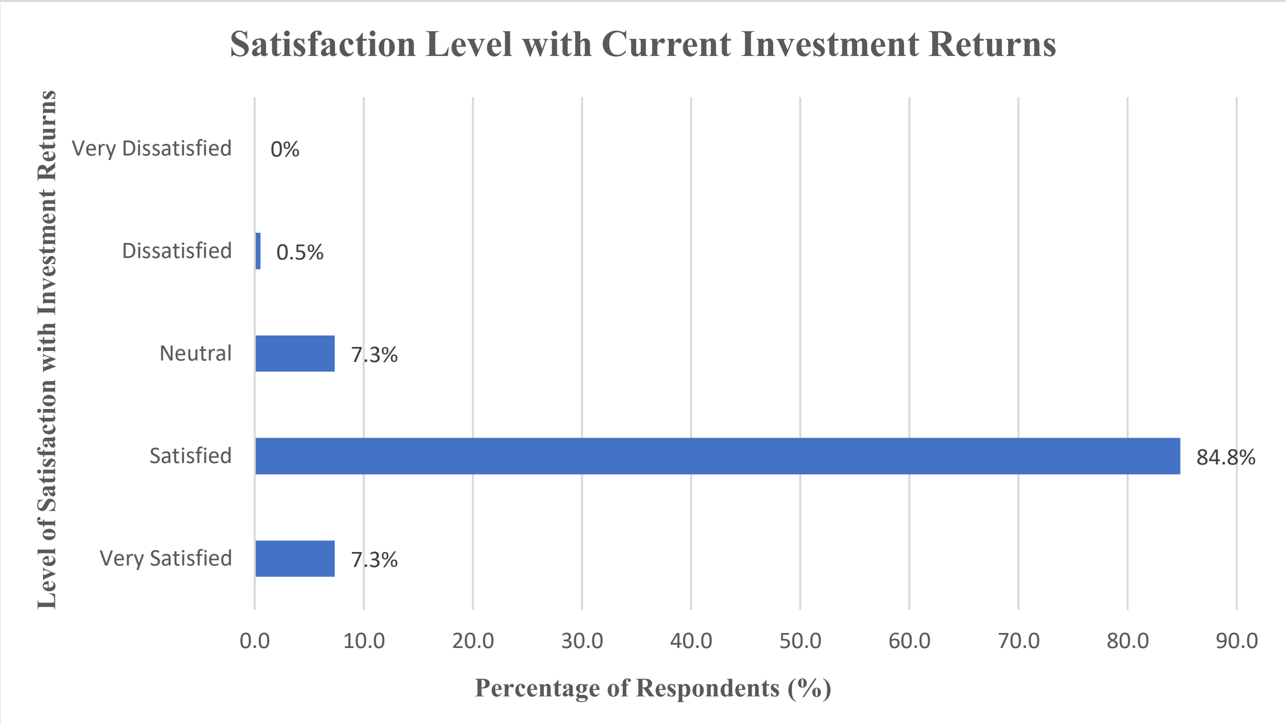
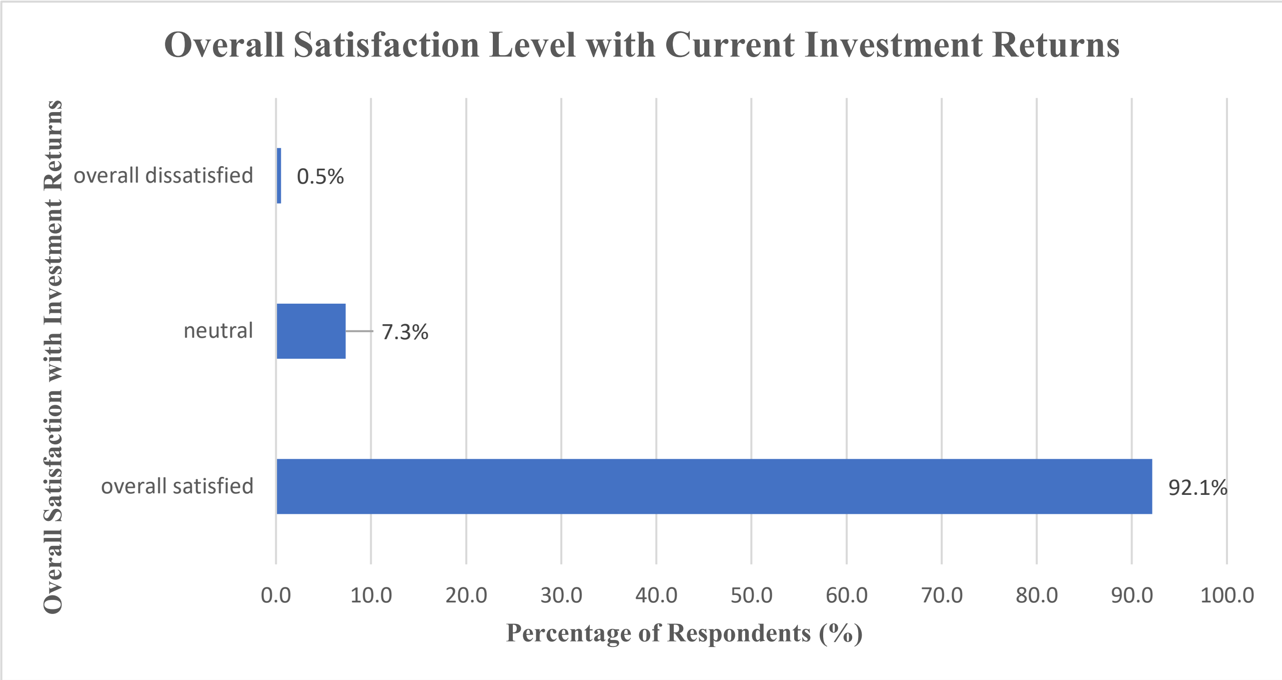


Table: Overall Satisfaction Level with Current Investment Returns

Table 4.1.23:

Category	Frequency	Percentage
Overall satisfied	176	92.1
Neutral	14	7.32
Overall dissatisfied	1	0.5
Total	**191**	**100**

Figure 4.1.21: Bar Chart Showing Respondents 'Overall Satisfaction Level with Current Investment Returns



Interpretation:

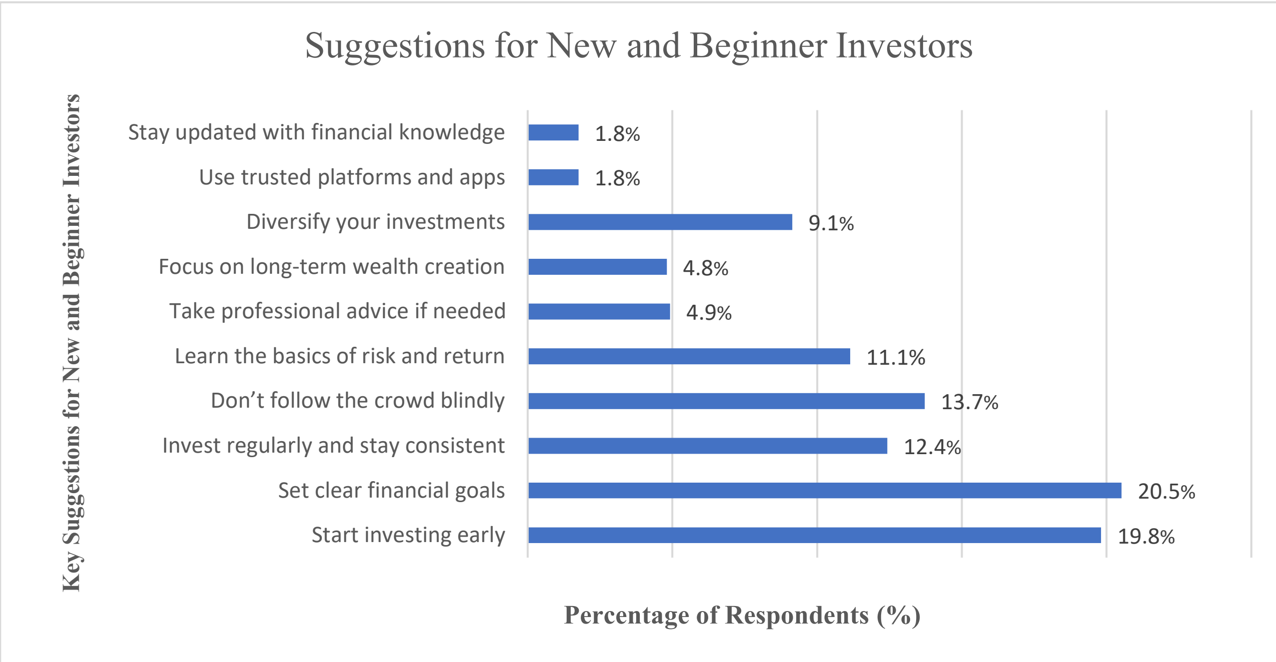
In this study, it was found that 92.1 per cent of respondents are overall satisfied with their current investment returns, while 7.3 per cent reported a neutral stance, and only 0.5 per cent expressed dissatisfaction. This indicates that the vast majority of participants feel positively about their investment outcomes, reflecting a generally successful and satisfactory investing experience among the respondents.

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.26

Table 4.1.24

Category	Frequency	percentage
Start investing early	169	19.8
Set clear financial goals	175	20.5
Invest regularly and stay consistent	106	12.4
Don't follow the crowd blindly	117	13.7
Learn the basics of risk and return	95	11.1
Take professional advice if needed	42	4.9
Focus on long-term wealth creation	41	4.8
Diversify your investments	78	9.1
Use trusted platforms and apps	15	1.8
Stay updated with financial knowledge	15	1.8
Total (in times)	**853**	**100**

Figure 4.1.22: Bar Chart Showing Suggestions Given by Respondents to New or Beginner Investors



Interpretation:

In this study, it was found that 20.5 per cent of the total suggestions were to set clear financial goals, followed closely by 19.8 per cent who recommended starting to invest early. Other frequently suggested advice included not following the crowd blindly (13.7 per cent), investing regularly and staying consistent (12.4 per cent), and learning the basics of risk and return (11.1 per cent). Fewer respondents suggested diversifying investments (9.1 per cent), taking professional advice if needed (4.9 per cent), focusing on long-term wealth creation (4.8 per cent), and using trusted platforms or staying updated with financial knowledge (both 1.8 per cent each). This indicates that most respondents emphasize the importance of setting goals and starting early, supported by disciplined and informed investing practices.

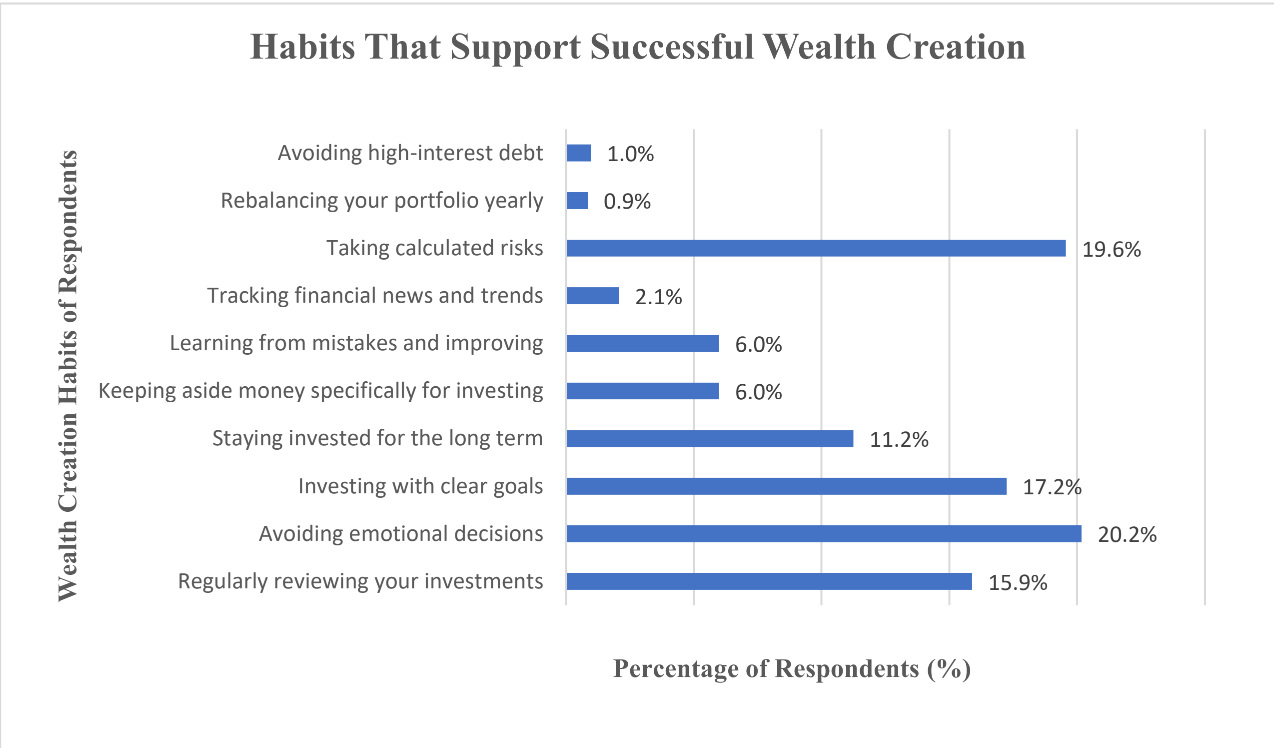
Note: Since this was a multiple-response question, the total frequency (853) reflects the number of times options were chosen, not the total number of respondents (191).

DATA ANALYSIS: QUESTION 4.1.27

Table 4.1.25:

Category	frequency	percentage
Regularly reviewing your investments	130	15.9
Avoiding emotional decisions	165	20.2
Investing with clear goals	141	17.2
Staying invested for the long term	92	11.2
Keeping aside money specifically for investing	49	6.0
Learning from mistakes and improving	49	6.0
Tracking financial news and trends	17	2.1
Taking calculated risks	160	19.6
Rebalancing your portfolio yearly	7	0.9
Avoiding high-interest debt	8	1.0
Total (in times)	818	100

Figure 4.1.23: Bar Chart Showing Habits Believed to Help in Successful Wealth Creation by Respondents



Interpretation:

In this study, it was found that 20.2 per cent of the total selections were for avoiding emotional decisions, followed closely by 19.6 per cent for taking calculated risks and 17.2 per cent for investing with clear goals. Other frequently chosen habits included regularly reviewing investments (15.9 per cent) and staying invested for the long term (11.2 per cent). Fewer respondents highlighted keeping aside money specifically for investing and learning from mistakes (both 6 per cent), while very few suggested tracking financial news and trends (2.1 per cent), avoiding high-interest debt (1 per cent), and rebalancing the portfolio yearly (0.9 per cent). This indicates that most respondents believe successful wealth creation is strongly linked to disciplined, goal-oriented, and rational investment habits.

Note: Since this was a multiple-response question, the total frequency (818) reflects the number of times options were chosen, not the total number of respondents (191).

4.2 Conclusion

The data analysis and interpretation phase of this study on **Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities** provided in-depth insights into how individual investors, particularly from Guwahati, Assam, approach their investment decisions, manage financial planning, and perceive risk and returns. Through careful analysis of responses gathered from 200 participants, several important conclusions have emerged.

The findings highlight that the majority of respondents belong to the mid-to-upper income segment and mainly comprise salaried individuals, reflecting a strong representation from working professionals. Most respondents actively invest, though a large proportion do so only occasionally rather than through strictly scheduled investments. Additionally, while a significant number plan their investments at least to some extent, only a smaller portion plan very carefully. Risk tolerance among respondents is predominantly moderate, indicating a preference for balanced strategies rather than highly aggressive or conservative approaches.

The analysis also shows that respondents Favor traditional and relatively safer investment options, with mutual funds, PPF, and fixed deposits among the most popular choices. Furthermore, the results reveal that most respondents are motivated to invest by long-term goals, wealth creation, and financial freedom, rather than by tax benefits or peer influence. Notably, a large majority of respondents check or monitor their investments on a quarterly or yearly basis, and many rely on digital tools like apps and websites for this purpose.

From the perspective of strategic investing, the study's Likert-scale analysis revealed that respondents generally hold positive attitudes toward disciplined and informed investing — valuing financial goal setting, risk awareness, and ongoing learning. The high Cronbach's Alpha value of 0.826945 confirms the internal consistency and reliability of these responses. However, hypothesis testing using Chi-square analysis showed that while respondents may have a clear strategy or believe in strategic investing, this does not necessarily translate into higher satisfaction with investment returns. Likewise, awareness of risk did not always align with investing in balanced options for safety and growth.

Overall, this study concludes that while respondents demonstrate responsible investment behaviour and strategic thinking, there remains room for improvement in systematic planning and translating awareness into balanced portfolio choices. These findings underscore the need for continued financial education, professional guidance, and awareness programs to help individual investors make better-informed, goal-driven investment decisions — ultimately supporting more sustainable wealth creation over time.

CHAPTER–5

FINDINGS, SUGGESTIONS AND CONCLUSION

5.1 INTRODUCTION

This study presents the findings of a detailed research project examining how individual investors in Guwahati, Assam, create wealth through strategic investment opportunities. The goal was to explore and understand the preferred investment avenues, risk tolerance, planning habits, financial awareness, and overall satisfaction with investment returns among retail investors.

In today's fast-changing economic environment, wealth creation is no longer limited to traditional options like fixed deposits or gold. Investors now have access to a wider range of strategic choices, including mutual funds, PPF, equity markets, and digital investment tools. By analysing how these choices, together with planning discipline and risk awareness, help build long-term wealth, the study aims to identify both strengths and gaps in current investment practices.

By closely analysing responses from 200 individual investors, this research provides valuable insights into investment behaviours, challenges faced, and areas where financial strategies can be improved. These insights can help beginners, financial educators, and policymakers promote more informed, disciplined, and goal-oriented investment practices – ultimately leading to better wealth creation outcomes.

5.2 Findings of the study

Objective 1: Examine preferred investment avenues, planning habits, risk tolerance, and financial awareness of individual investors

- **High Participation in Investing**: The study found that 95.5% of respondents currently invest money, showing a proactive shift from traditional saving to active investing.
- **Popular Investment Choices**: Mutual funds emerged as the most preferred option (30.4%), followed by Public Provident Fund (13.3%), fixed deposits (11.8%), insurance products (10.9%), gold/silver (10.8%), and stocks (10.3%). This shows that while investors are open to different products, they lean towards options balancing growth with safety.
- **Investment Frequency and Commitment**: Most respondents (61.8%) invest occasionally rather than monthly (26.7%), and about 68.1% invest between 10–25% of their income. This indicates moderate but steady investment habits.
- **Risk Tolerance and Planning**: A large share (83.2%) have a moderate risk tolerance, aiming for balanced growth instead of taking very high or very low risks. While 28% plan investments carefully, the majority (72%) plan only somewhat, and none reported investing completely at random – reflecting some level of planning awareness but scope for improvement in detailed financial planning.
- **Use of Digital Tools and Advice**: About 71% use apps or websites to track and manage investments, indicating comfort with digital tools. However, more respondents rely on advice from family and friends (51.8%) than from professional advisors (35.1%).
- **Investment Motivations**: The main drivers for investing are financial freedom (35.4%), building long-term wealth (35.1%), and retirement planning (25.2%). Very few cited tax benefits or peer influence as primary motivations.

Objective 2: Evaluate investor satisfaction and attitudes toward strategic investing

- **Overall Satisfaction:** About 92% of respondents reported being satisfied with their current investment returns, even though only a small fraction described themselves as "very satisfied."

- **Strategic Mindset:** Many respondents agree that strategic investing is better than merely saving in a bank. High scores on statements like willingness to learn more about investing and following investment-related articles reflect an interest in continuous financial learning.
- **Reliability of Responses:** A Cronbach's Alpha score of approximately 0.82 indicates strong internal consistency among answers, suggesting that most respondents hold reasonably clear views about investing and wealth creation.
- **Insight from Chi-square Tests**: Statistical analysis showed that while many respondents believe in the value of having a strategy and understand investment risks, these beliefs do *not* always lead to actually creating clear written strategies, choosing balanced investment options, or feeling more satisfied with returns. This suggests that positive attitudes alone are not enough; practical, structured planning is also needed.

Objective 3: Provide strategic recommendations for improving wealth creation among new and beginner investors

- **Need for Goal-Based Planning:** The data shows that the most common advice experienced investors gave to beginners was to set clear financial goals (20.5%). This suggests that many new investors don't plan their investments around specific life goals — and that making a clear plan is seen as the first important step to build wealth.
- **Start Early and Be Consistent:** About 19.8% of respondents advised beginners to start investing early, and 12.4% suggested to invest regularly and stay consistent. This means experienced investors believe that starting early and investing every month — instead of occasionally — helps beginners grow their money steadily over time.
- **Control Emotions and Take Smart Risks:** When asked about habits that help create wealth, most respondents chose avoiding emotional decisions (20.2%) and taking calculated risks (19.6%). This shows that beginners often react too quickly to market ups and downs, and need to learn to stay calm and make thoughtful, balanced choices.
- **Learn and Seek Expert Advice:** Many respondents also said beginners should learn the basics of risk and return (11.1%) and not follow the crowd blindly (13.7%). While fewer people (4.9%) mentioned taking professional advice, it still shows the value of asking experts instead of relying only on friends or trends.

Overall Insight: The findings show that new investors often miss out on making detailed plans, investing regularly, and keeping emotions in check. The advice from experienced investors highlights the need to improve financial knowledge, start early, invest with clear goals, and get help from trusted experts — all of which can help beginners build wealth more effectively.

5.3 Suggestions

- **Promote Goal-Based Financial Planning**: Encourage new and beginner investors to move beyond general awareness and start setting clear, specific financial goals. Findings showed that only 28% of respondents plan their investments in detail, and the most common suggestion from experienced investors (20.5%) was to set clear financial goals. Financial institutions, advisors, and educational platforms can support this by providing tools, workshops, and guidance to help beginners link their investments to concrete life goals, making their approach more structured and disciplined.
- **Develop Regular and Early Investing Habits**: The data revealed that 61.8% of respondents invest only occasionally rather than monthly. In contrast, 19.8% recommended starting early, and 12.4% advised investing regularly and staying consistent. New investors should be encouraged to start early and adopt systematic investing habits through instruments like SIPs or recurring deposits, laying the foundation for long-term financial stability through consistent habits.
- **Enhance Financial Literacy and Emotional Discipline:** Findings showed that many respondents believe successful wealth creation depends on avoiding emotional decisions (20.2%) and taking calculated risks (19.6%). Targeted workshops, webinars, and digital learning resources can teach beginners about risk-return trade-offs, diversification, and tax planning. This will help them make rational, goal-oriented investment decisions while minimizing emotionally driven errors during market fluctuations.
- **Encourage Balanced Portfolio Building**: Although most respondents reported moderate risk tolerance (83.2%), this awareness did not always translate into balanced investment choices. Beginners should be guided to diversify across different asset classes — such as equity, debt, and gold — to spread risk and enhance growth potential. Financial advisors and digital investment apps can play a key role by recommending balanced portfolios tailored to each investor's risk profile and long-term goals.
- **Facilitate Access to Professional Advice**: Over half of respondents (51.8%) rely mainly on family and friends for investment decisions, while only 35.1% consult professionals. Financial institutions and fintech platforms can address this gap by offering affordable, unbiased advisory services — including certified financial planners and robo-advisory tools — enabling beginners to make more informed, evidence-based investment choices.

Together, these Suggestions aim to help new and beginner investors become more disciplined, better informed, and more confident — helping beginners achieve sustainable wealth creation.

5.4 Conclusion

Based on the findings and recommendations, this study provides a detailed analysis of how individual investors in Guwahati, Assam approach wealth creation through strategic investment opportunities. The research highlights that while a large majority of respondents actively invest and show a preference for balanced products like mutual funds and PPF, many beginners still lack detailed, goal-based financial planning. Most investors plan their investments only "somewhat," and tend to invest occasionally rather than on a disciplined monthly basis.

The analysis also revealed that although most respondents are aware of investment risks and have moderate risk tolerance, this awareness does not always translate into balanced and diversified portfolios. Many new investors rely mainly on informal advice from family and friends, with only a smaller share consulting professional advisors, which may limit access to more advanced strategies. Additionally, while digital tools are used by over 70% of respondents, these are often limited to tracking rather than deeper planning and portfolio management.

To address these gaps, the study recommends promoting goal-based financial planning, encouraging early and regular investing habits, enhancing financial literacy to reduce emotional decision-making, and guiding beginners toward building balanced portfolios. Facilitating wider access to affordable, professional advice — both through certified planners and digital advisory tools — is also crucial for helping new investors make informed choices.

By implementing these recommendations, stakeholders including financial educators, policymakers, and fintech platforms can help new and beginner investors become more disciplined, knowledgeable, and confident. This, in turn, can lead to more sustainable wealth creation, improved financial security, and greater participation in the broader investment ecosystem — ultimately supporting long-term economic well-being for individuals and the community.

CHAPTER–6

Researcher's Individual Recommendation

6.1 Researcher's Individual Recommendation

While the previous chapter focused on general suggestions derived from the data collected during the study, this chapter presents my personal recommendation as the researcher. Based on the insights gained from analyzing responses, interacting with investors, and reflecting on common challenges observed throughout the study, I am sharing this individual recommendation to support new and beginner investors in their journey toward wealth creation.

This recommendation is shaped not only by the survey findings but also by my understanding of the gaps in investor behavior, planning habits, and mindset — and aims to provide a simple, realistic approach that beginners can apply with confidence. Based on the overall study, analysis, and personal learning during this research, I would like to give my individual recommendation for helping new and beginner investors in the process of wealth creation. After going through all the responses and interacting with investors, I understood that the main issue is not a lack of investment options, but rather the lack of proper planning, awareness, and consistency. Most people know about mutual funds, PPF, FDs, etc., but they do not know how to use them correctly as per their goals. This creates confusion and stops them from investing with confidence.

In my opinion, I strongly recommend that beginners should first be guided to set clear financial goals — whether it is for retirement, home, emergency fund, or education. Once the goal is fixed, then small and regular investments can be started using SIPs or recurring deposits. This not only builds discipline but also helps in creating wealth slowly and steadily over time. People often delay investments thinking they don't have enough money, but starting with even ₹100–₹500 a month can make a difference if done regularly.

Also, the data clearly showed that many investors are still depending on friends or relatives for advice, and not many are reaching out to professionals. While apps like SBI YONO already offer tools and investment options, many beginners still don't know how to properly use those features. So, I recommend that banks and platforms should introduce a more interactive and personalised guidance system — like step-by-step investment journeys, auto-reminder nudges, or beginner-friendly "investment walkthroughs" that guide users based on their age, income, and goals. There can also be a regular follow-up system (through notifications or WhatsApp bots) to encourage habit formation. This will ensure that users not only have access to tools, but also use them consistently and correctly, without feeling overwhelmed or confused.

Finally, based on everything I learned, I personally feel that the real key to wealth creation lies in financial awareness, emotional control, and consistent habits. People do not need to be experts or invest large amounts — they just need to be regular, informed, and stay calm during ups and downs. If this mindset is developed from the beginning, then wealth creation becomes a natural and lifelong process.

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ANNEXURE - I

Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities

Respected Sir/Madam,
I, Manash Boro, a student of MBA 2nd Year at Don Bosco Institute of Management, am currently undergoing a two-month internship at the State Bank Institute of Learning and Development (SBILD), Guwahati. The topic of my internship project is **"Wealth Creation through Strategic Investment Opportunities."**

As a partial requirement for the successful completion of this project, I am conducting this questionnaire survey.

You are kindly requested to spare a few minutes of your valuable time to answer the following questions. Your responses will be kept confidential and will be used solely for research and analysis purposes.

<u>Section A: Demographics</u>

Name (optional): ______________________________

1. Age group:

- o 18–25
- o 26–35
- o 36–45
- o 46–55
- o 56–65 and above

2. Gender:

- o Male
- o Female
- o Prefer not to say

3. Monthly income (INR):

- o Less than 20,000
- o 20,001 – 50,000
- o 50,001 – 1,00,000
- o Above 1,00,000

4. Occupation:

- o Student
- o Salaried employee
- o Self-employed / Business
- o Retired

<u>Section B: Investment Profile</u>

5. Do you currently invest money?

- o Yes
- o No

6. How often do you invest?

- o Monthly

- Quarterly
- Occasionally
- Rarely

7. What percentage of your income do you invest?

- I don’t know
- Less than 10%
- 10–25%
- 25–50%
- More than 50%
- Prefer not to say

8. What are your main investment options? ***(Select all that apply)***

- Fixed Deposit
- Mutual Funds
- Stocks
- Public Provident Fund (PPF)
- Cryptocurrency
- Gold/Silver
- Real Estate
- NPS (national pension scheme)
- Insurance (Life, Health,Term , or Other)

9. Do you plan your investments or invest randomly?

- Yes, I plan carefully
- Somewhat
- No planning

10. What is your risk tolerance? *

- Low
- Moderate
- High

11. Do you invest with a long-term goal (5+ years)?

- Yes
- No
- Maybe

12. Have you taken any financial or investment advice?

- Yes, from a professional
- Yes, from family/friends
- No

13. Do you use apps or websites to manage your investments?

- Yes
- No

14. What motivates you to invest? (Select all that apply)

- Retirement or future planning
- To build long-term wealth
- Tax benefits
- Peer influence (e.g., friends/family recommended it)
- Financial freedom

15. How often do you check/monitor your investments?

- Daily
- Weekly
- Monthly
- Quarterly
- Yearly
- Rarely

Section C: Attitudes and Knowledge about Investment

For each statement, select one option:

Question no	QUESTION	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
16	I understand the difference between saving and investing.	1	2	3	4	5
17	I am aware of the risks in the investment options I choose	1	2	3	4	5
18	I prefer long-term investment over short-term trading.	1	2	3	4	5
19	I regularly read articles or content related to investment strategies	1	2	3	4	5
20	I avoid investing in high-risk options without proper research	1	2	3	4	5
21	I believe investing is essential for future financial security.	1	2	3	4	5
22	I feel confident in managing my own investments.	1	2	3	4	5
23	I review and rebalance my portfolio regularly.	1	2	3	4	5
24	I am satisfied with the returns I get	1	2	3	4	5

	from my current investments.					
25	I invest in options that give both safety and growth.	1	2	3	4	5
26	I set clear financial goals for each investment.	1	2	3	4	5
27	I have a clear strategy for wealth creation.	1	2	3	4	5
28	I would like to learn more about smart investing.	1	2	3	4	5
29	I make investment decisions based on research and facts, not emotions	1	2	3	4	5
30	I believe strategic investing is better than just saving in a bank.	1	2	3	4	5

Investment Satisfaction Level

		Very Satisfied	Satisfied	Neutral	Dissatisfied	Very Dissatisfied
31	Are you satisfied with your current investment returns?	1	2	3	4	5

Suggestions for New Investors

32. What suggestions would you give to new or beginner investors? (Select all that apply)

- Start investing early
- Set clear financial goals
- Invest regularly and stay consistent
- Don’t follow the crowd blindly
- Learn the basics of risk and return
- Take professional advice if needed
- Focus on long-term wealth creation
- Diversify your investments
- Use trusted platforms and apps
- Stay updated with financial knowledge

33. Which of the following habits do you believe help in successful wealth creation? (Select all that apply)

- Regularly reviewing your investments
- Avoiding emotional decisions
- Investing with clear goals
- Staying invested for the long term
- Keeping aside money specifically for investing
- Learning from mistakes and improving
- Tracking financial news and trends
- Taking calculated risks
- Rebalancing your portfolio yearly
- Avoiding high-interest debt